🎯 AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION

The Proving Grounds

CTF Practice, Labs & Hacking Training

74	120,195	43%	14
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

Intro: Hack legally — wargames, CTF platforms and deliberately-vulnerable apps to sharpen your skills.

Deep-research edition. Every entry re-verified and enriched with live GitHub statistics (stars, first release, last push, license, language) pulled 2026-10-17 via the GitHub API, plus per-realm field intelligence. Tool profiles rank the realm's most-adopted projects and note who uses each tool and the commercial product it replaces; the full inventory keeps every curated entry.

Part of Awesome Cyber Security Heaven — **444 curated free tools across 14 realms**.

github.com/RanaKhan77/awesome-cyber-security-heaven
CC0 · 2026-10-17

01 Realm Intelligence

live GitHub census · 2026-10-17

74	32	120,195	14	1,153	2010
CURATED TOOLS	ON GITHUB	COMBINED STARS	PUSHED 2026	MEDIAN STARS	OLDEST ENTRY

REALM BRIEF

Intro: Hack legally — wargames, CTF platforms and deliberately-vulnerable apps to sharpen your skills.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE (AI-ASSISTED)

The Proving Grounds realm, a curated collection of CTF practice, labs, and hacking training tools, launched its oldest entry in July 2010 and now holds 74 total tools, with 32 hosted on GitHub representing 43% of the curated set. Adoption is heavily concentrated in its top five starred tools: Vulhub, OWASP Juice Shop, DVWA, pwntools, and WebGoat, which account for 72.8% of the combined 120,195 total stars, with a median of 1,153 stars across all tools. Only 14 tools received code pushes in 2026, indicating limited active maintenance for most of the collection, while quiet classics like Metasploitable 3, WackoPicko, OWASP NodeGoat, and lfi-labs have not seen recent updates. The most notable trend is the dominance of Python and PHP as core development languages for the tools, alongside a license mix weighted toward GPL and MIT terms, reflecting open-source community norms for security training resources.

Synthesized by seed-2-0-mini over the live census: stars, first-release years, push activity and project claims pulled from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17. Human-curated realm, AI-summarized numbers.

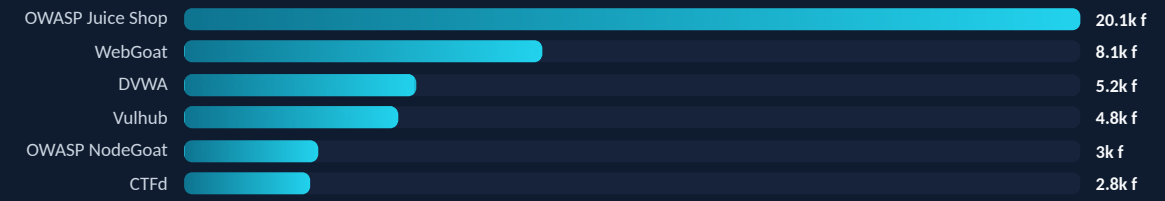
01 The Adoption Map

who the community actually stars

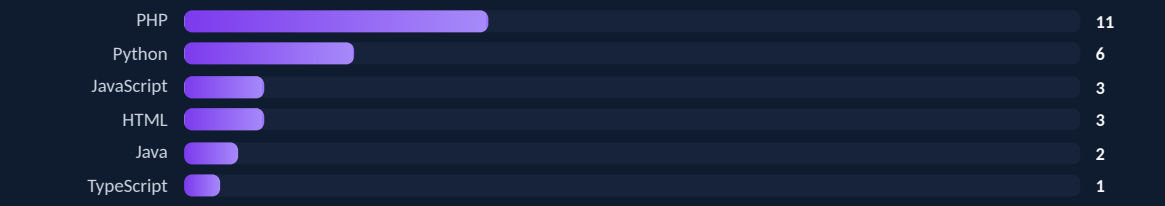
TOP TOOLS BY GITHUB STARS



MOST-FORKED — REAL-WORLD REUSE SIGNAL



LANGUAGE MIX — GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



01 Generations & Momentum

the realm's age structure

THE FOUNDERS — OLDEST TRACKED ENTRIES

WackoPicko	2010-07-16
CryptOMG	2012-06-11
Hackademic	2012-09-23
pwntools	2013-04-29
DVWA	2013-05-01

THE NEWCOMERS — NEWEST GITHUB ARRIVALS

AzureGoat	2022-08
GOAD	2021-09
0l4bs	2020-02
Splunk Attack Range	2019-05
OWASP Mutillidae II	2018-09

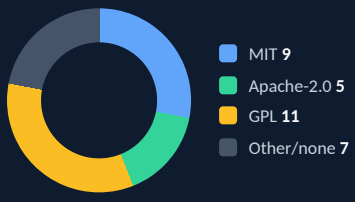
CREATION ERAS — WHEN THE REALM WAS BUILT

2008-2012	2013-2016	2017-2020	2021-2026
3	18	9	2

QUIET CLASSICS (NO 2026 PUSH, STILL THE STANDARD)

Metasploitable 3, WackoPicko, OWASP NodeGoat, lfi-labs, 0l4bs, DVHMA

LICENSE MIX — GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



02 Tool Profiles — the heavyweights

full-page dossiers · ranked by adoption

Each heavyweight gets a full dossier: live GitHub census (stars, forks, first-release year, last push, license, language), the project's own claim, our curator's note, **who uses it and which commercial product it replaces**, and its star weight against the realm's #1.

Profiles are ordered by GitHub adoption (stars). Non-GitHub entries follow, alphabetically. Flagship marks the realm's top 8 by stars.

01 Vulhub

github.com/vulhub/vulhub

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 21.4k	GITHUB STARS
4,819	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Dockerfile	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Pre-Built Vulnerable Environments Based on Docker-Compose"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

dockerized vulnerable environments: spin up a CVE, test, tear down.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by learners spinning up vulnerable environments with Docker; the free compose-file library of real CVE setups.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



9	4,819	55	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

02 OWASP Juice Shop

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

github.com/juice-shop/juice-shop

star weight vs realm #1



★ 14.1k	GITHUB STARS
20,085	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2014	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
TypeScript	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OWASP Juice Shop: Probably the most modern and sophisticated insecure web application"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the modern deliberately-vulnerable app with gamified challenges covering the whole OWASP spectrum. Used in corporate trainings and university courses; the de facto standard vulnerable app for web security practice.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



12	20,085	6	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

03 DVWA

github.com/digininja/DVWA

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 13.9k	GITHUB STARS
5,204	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
PHP	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Damn Vulnerable Web Application (DVWA)"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the classic Damn Vulnerable Web Application for safely learning injection basics.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by instructors teaching web vulnerabilities for years; the classic PHP vulnerable app in every classroom lab.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



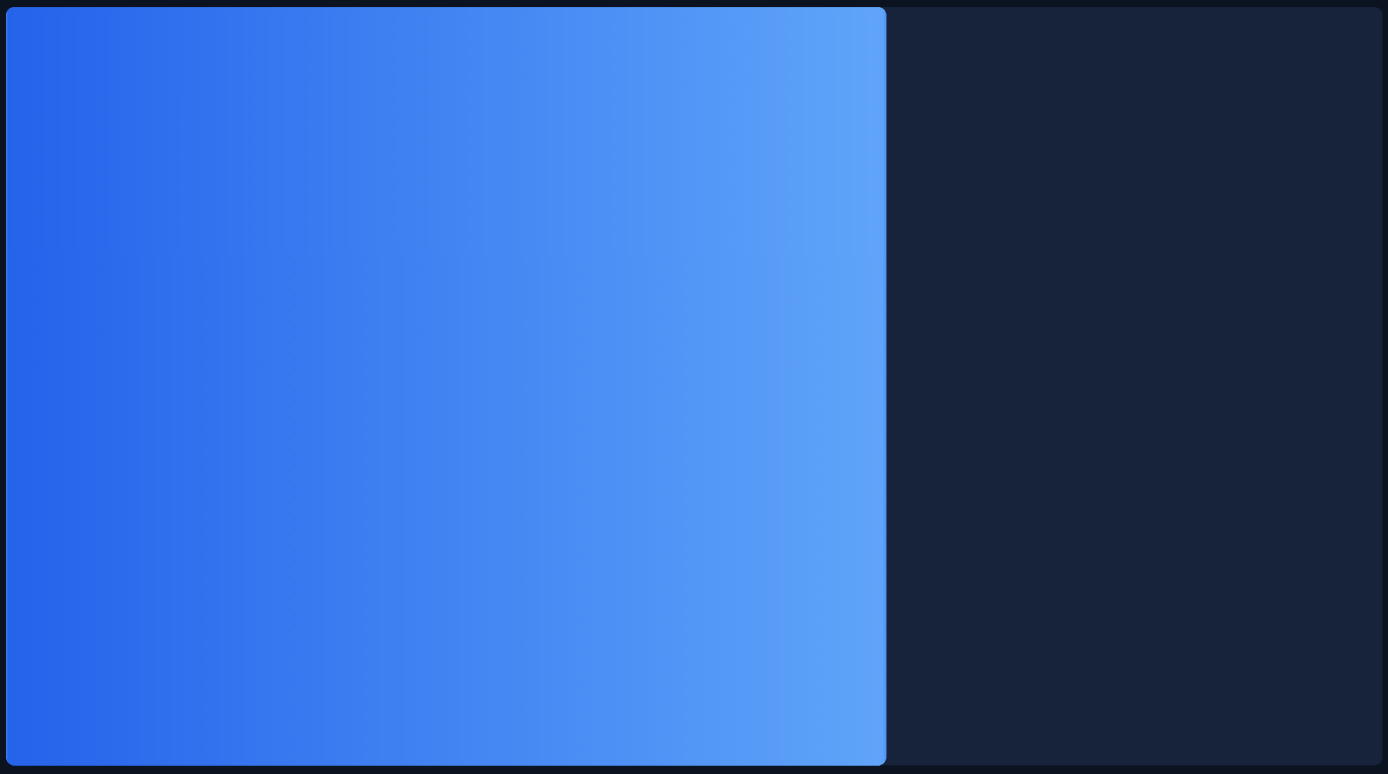
13	5,204	8	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

04 pwntools

github.com/Gallopsled/pwntools

★ FLAGSHIP PICK
ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 13.8k	GITHUB STARS
1,864	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"CTF framework and exploit development library"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the CTF exploit-development library: from sockets to ROP chains, pwn everything.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by CTF players and exploit developers writing exploits fast; the standard Python library for pwn challenges.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



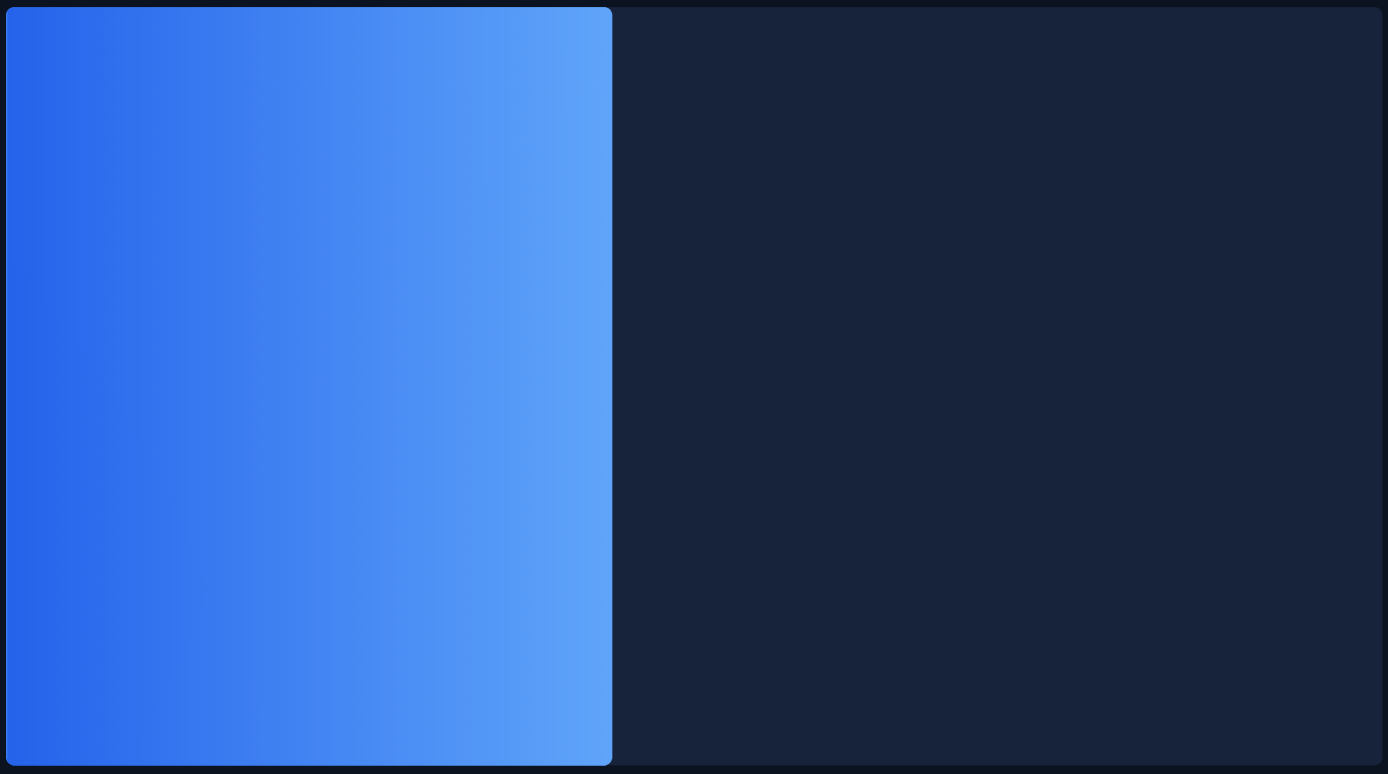
13	1,864	126	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

05 WebGoat

github.com/WebGoat/WebGoat

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 9.4k	GITHUB STARS
8,076	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
JavaScript	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"WebGoat is a deliberately insecure application"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

OWASP's teaching app: guided lessons with a solution walkthrough for each vulnerability class.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by Java teams and instructors learning web exploitation; the OWASP teaching app with lessons built in.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11	8,076	35	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

06 GOAD

github.com/Orange-Cyberdefense/GOAD

★ FLAGSHIP PICK
ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 8.5k	GITHUB STARS
1,166	FORKS
2026-03	LAST PUSH
2021	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
PowerShell	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"game of active directory"

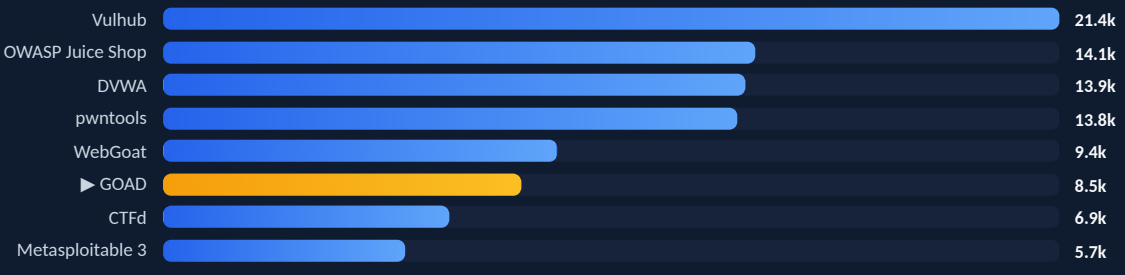
CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Game of Active Directory: a three-forest lab purpose-built for safely practicing AD attack techniques.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by AD red-team trainees practicing real attack paths; the free Game of Active Directory lab commercial courses emulate.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



5	1,166	152	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

07 CTFd

github.com/CTFd/CTFd

★ FLAGSHIP PICK ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 6.9k	GITHUB STARS
2,768	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"CTFs as you need them"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the CTF platform that powers thousands of events; self-host your own competition.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by CTF organizers self-hosting competitions; the open-source platform behind thousands of events.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



11	2,768	430	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

08 Metasploitable 3

github.com/rapid7/metasploitable3

★ FLAGSHIP PICK

star weight vs realm #1



★ 5.7k	GITHUB STARS
1,272	FORKS
2025-02	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
HTML	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Metasploitable3 is a VM that is built from the ground up with a large amount of security vulnerabilities."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Rapid7's purpose-built vulnerable target VM; the canonical Metasploit practice range.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by pentest trainees practicing Metasploit workflows; the Rapid7-blessed free practice target.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



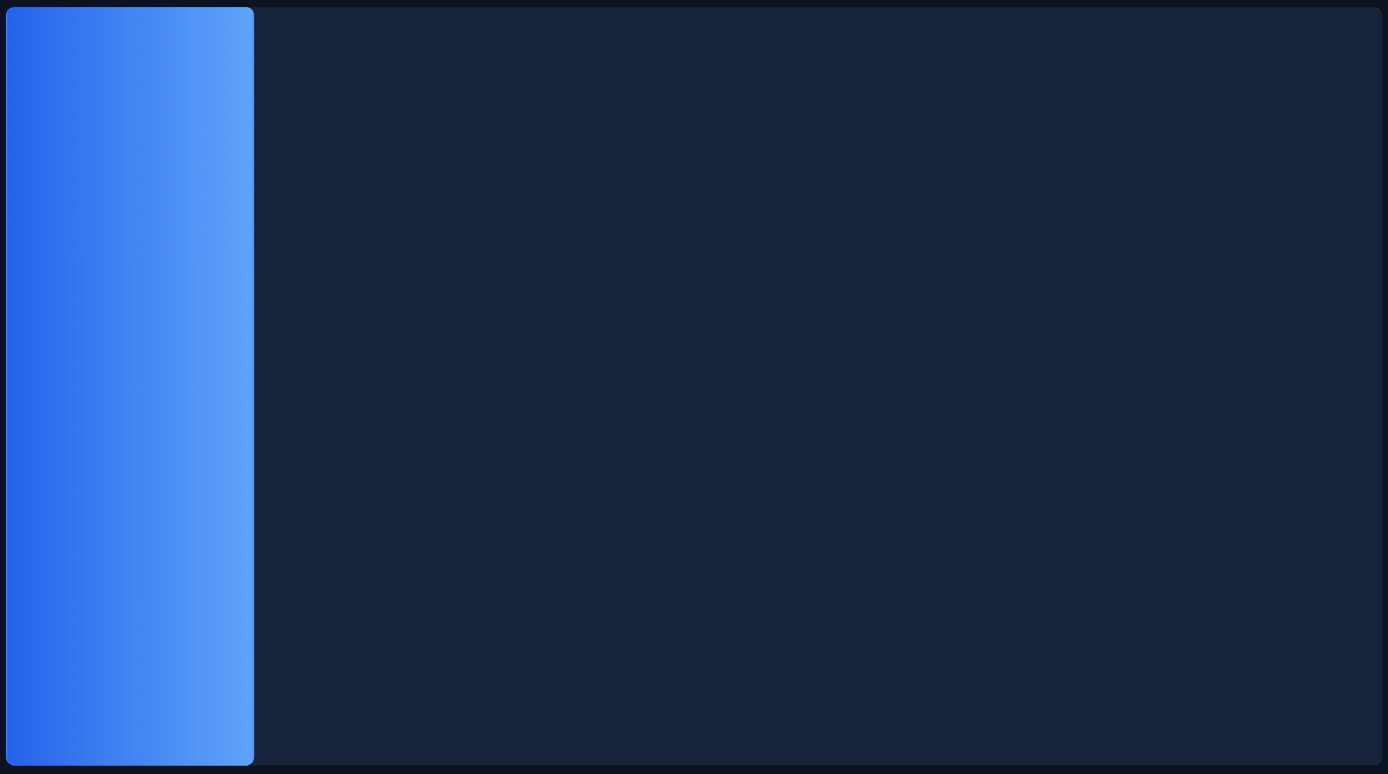
10	1,272	73	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

09 CloudGoat

github.com/RhinoSecurityLabs/cloudgoat

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.8k	GITHUB STARS
774	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
BSD-3-Clause	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"CloudGoat is Rhino Security Labs' "Vulnerable by Design" AWS deployment tool"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Rhino Security's "vulnerable by design" AWS scenarios — deploy, attack, tear down.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by cloud security learners practicing AWS attacks safely; Rhino Security's free vulnerable-by-design deployment.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

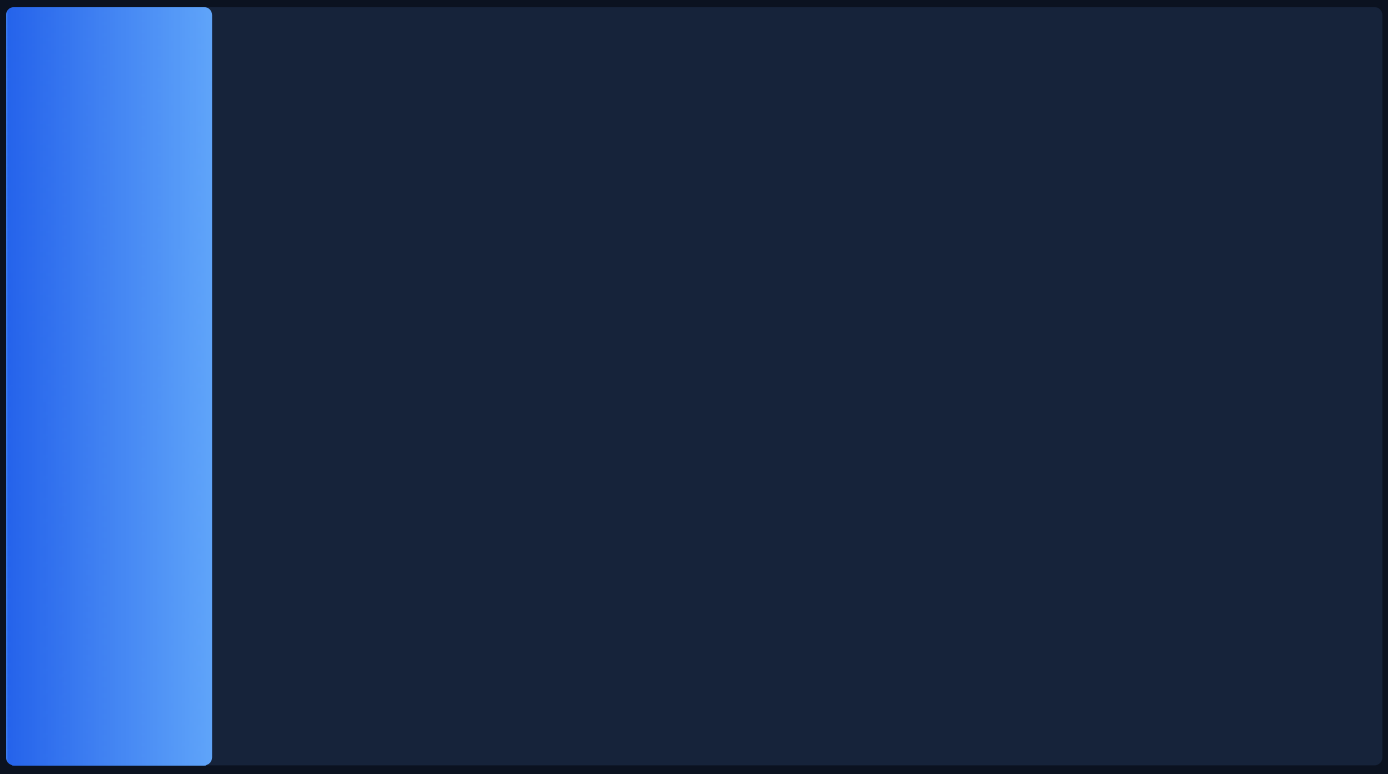


8	774	19	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

10 HEVD

github.com/hacksysteam/HackSysExtremeVulnerableDriver

star weight vs realm #1



★ 3.1k	GITHUB STARS
587	FORKS
2025-02	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
C	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"HackSys Extreme Vulnerable Driver (HEVD) - Windows & Linux"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Windows kernel-driver training target for exploit development.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by kernel exploit developers learning Windows driver exploitation; the free HackSys training driver with documented vulns.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

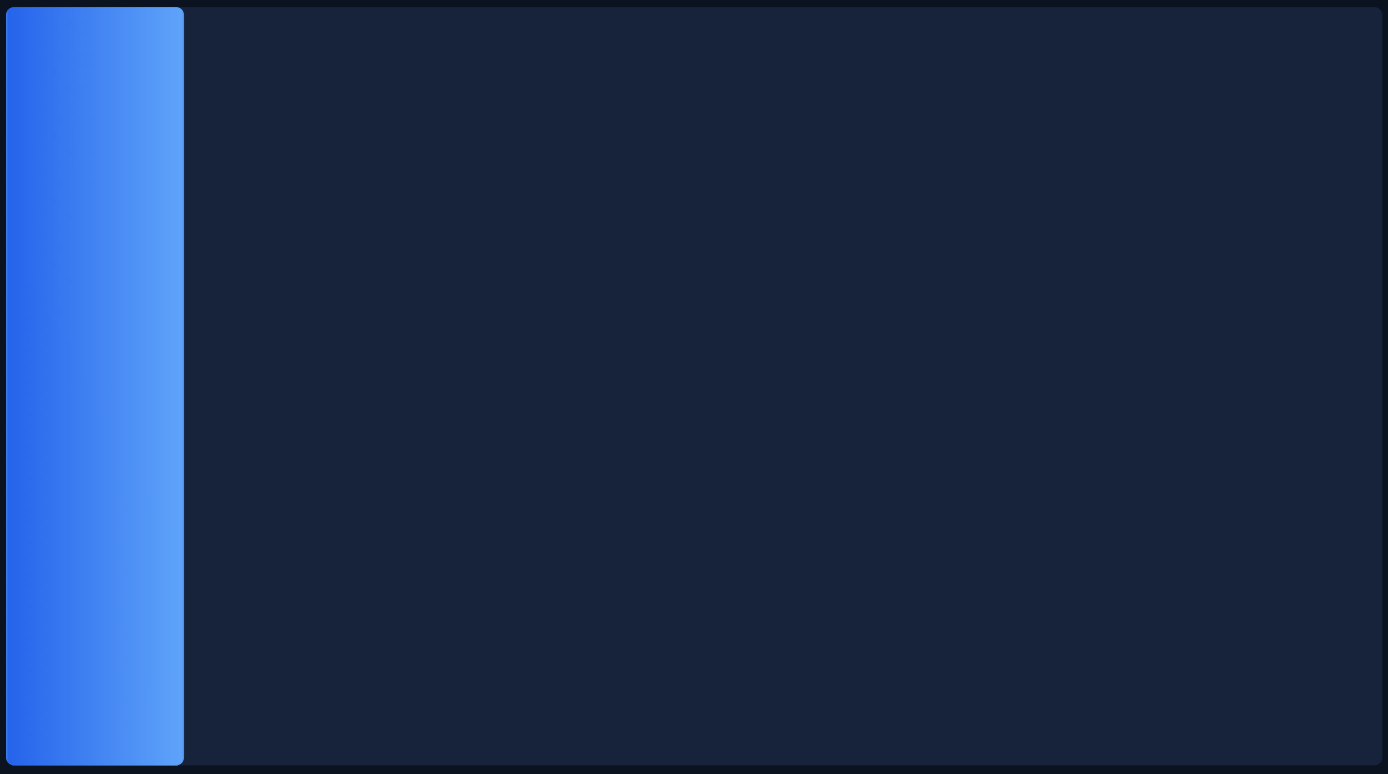


11	587	14	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

11 APTSimulator

github.com/NextronSystems/APTSimulator

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.8k	GITHUB STARS
453	FORKS
2025-09	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Batchfile	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A toolset to make a system look as if it was the victim of an APT attack"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

makes a Windows host look compromised so you can test detections safely.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by blue teams generating APT-style artifacts for detection testing; the free Windows simulator for purple exercises.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



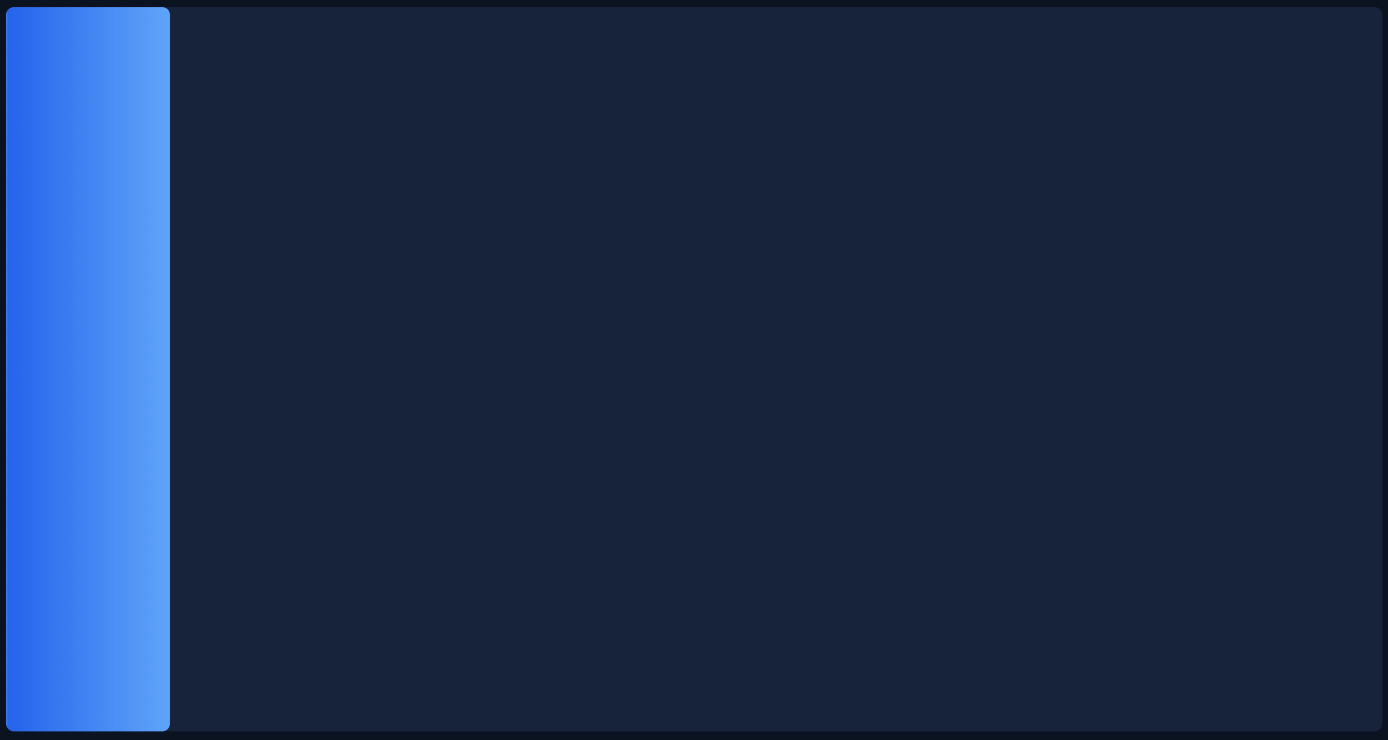
8	453	4	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

12 Splunk Attack Range

github.com/splunk/attack_range

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.6k	GITHUB STARS
417	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2019	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A tool that allows you to create vulnerable instrumented local or cloud environments to simulate attacks against and collect the data into Splunk"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

builds instrumented detection labs: attack, collect and test in one workflow.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by detection engineers building full attack/defend labs in the cloud; the free Splunk range that emulates commercial cyber ranges.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

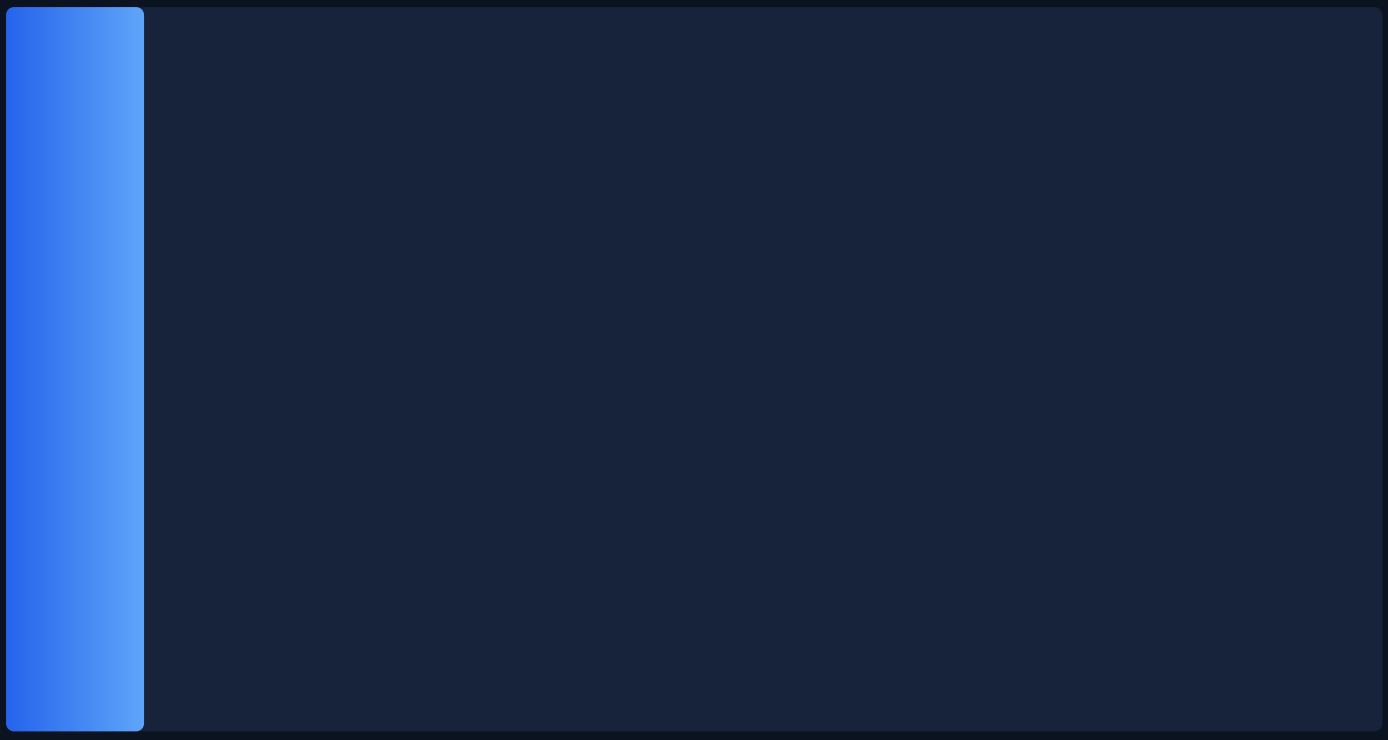


7	417	15	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

13 OWASP NodeGoat

github.com/OWASP/NodeGoat

star weight vs realm #1



★ 2.1k	GITHUB STARS
3,033	FORKS
2024-06	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
HTML	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"The OWASP NodeGoat project provides an environment to learn how OWASP Top 10 security risks apply to web applications developed using Node.js and how to effectively address them."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Node.js vulnerable-by-design app: the Top 10 in a controllable lab.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by Node.js teams learning the OWASP Top 10 in their stack; the OWASP training app for JavaScript.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

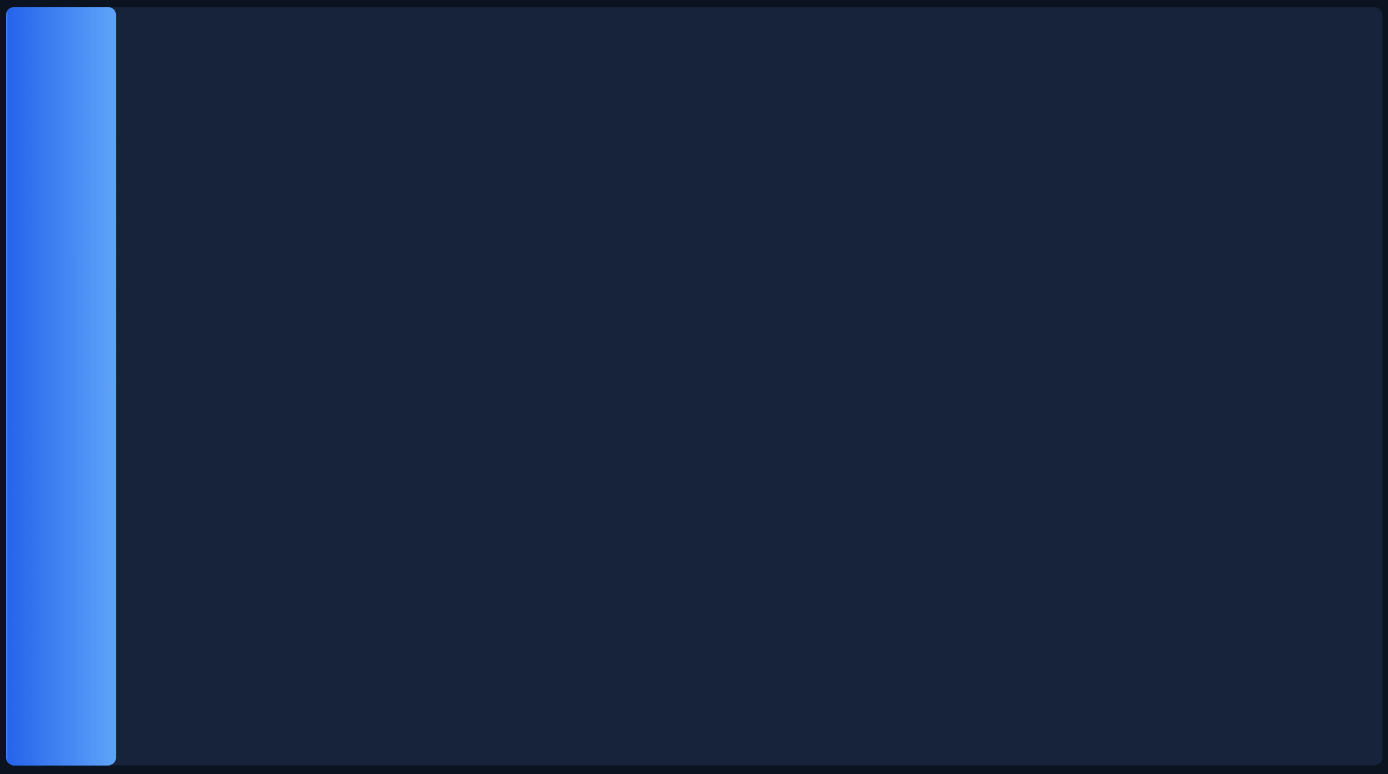


13	3,033	119	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

14 XVWA

github.com/s4n7h0/xvwa

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.8k	GITHUB STARS
364	FORKS
2020-09	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
PHP	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"XVWA is a badly coded web application written in PHP/MySQL that helps security enthusiasts to learn application security."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Xtreme Vulnerable Web Application: dozens of flaws across one PHP app.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by testers practicing the full OWASP range on one app; the Xtreme Vulnerable Web Application.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



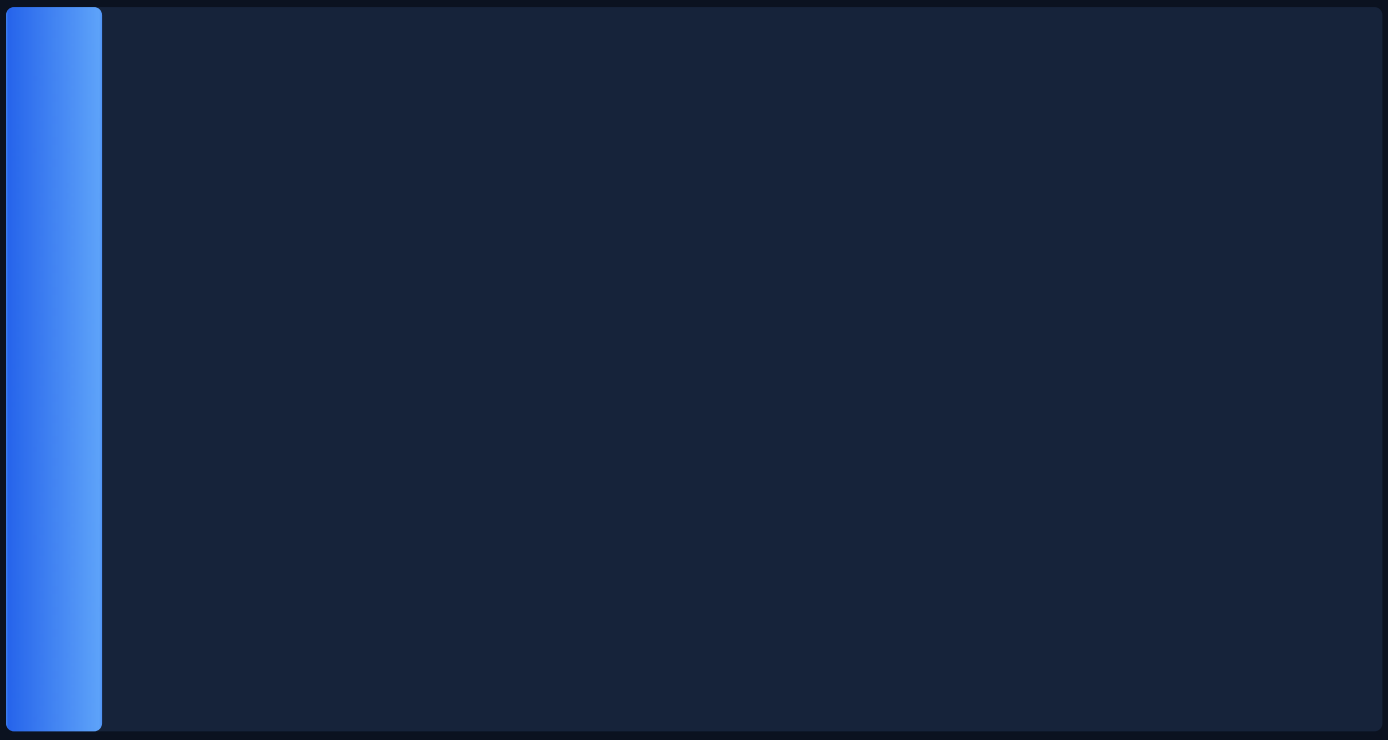
11	364	6	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

15 OWASP Mutillidae II

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/webpwnized/mutillidae

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.5k	GITHUB STARS
566	FORKS
2026-09	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
PHP	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OWASP Mutillidae II is a free, open-source, deliberately vulnerable web application providing a target for web-security training. This is an easy-to-use web hacking environment designed for labs, security enthusiasts, cl"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

deliberately vulnerable app that re-creates every OWASP Top 10 issue, resettable per install.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by teachers demonstrating nearly every OWASP vulnerability; the deliberately vulnerable training app.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

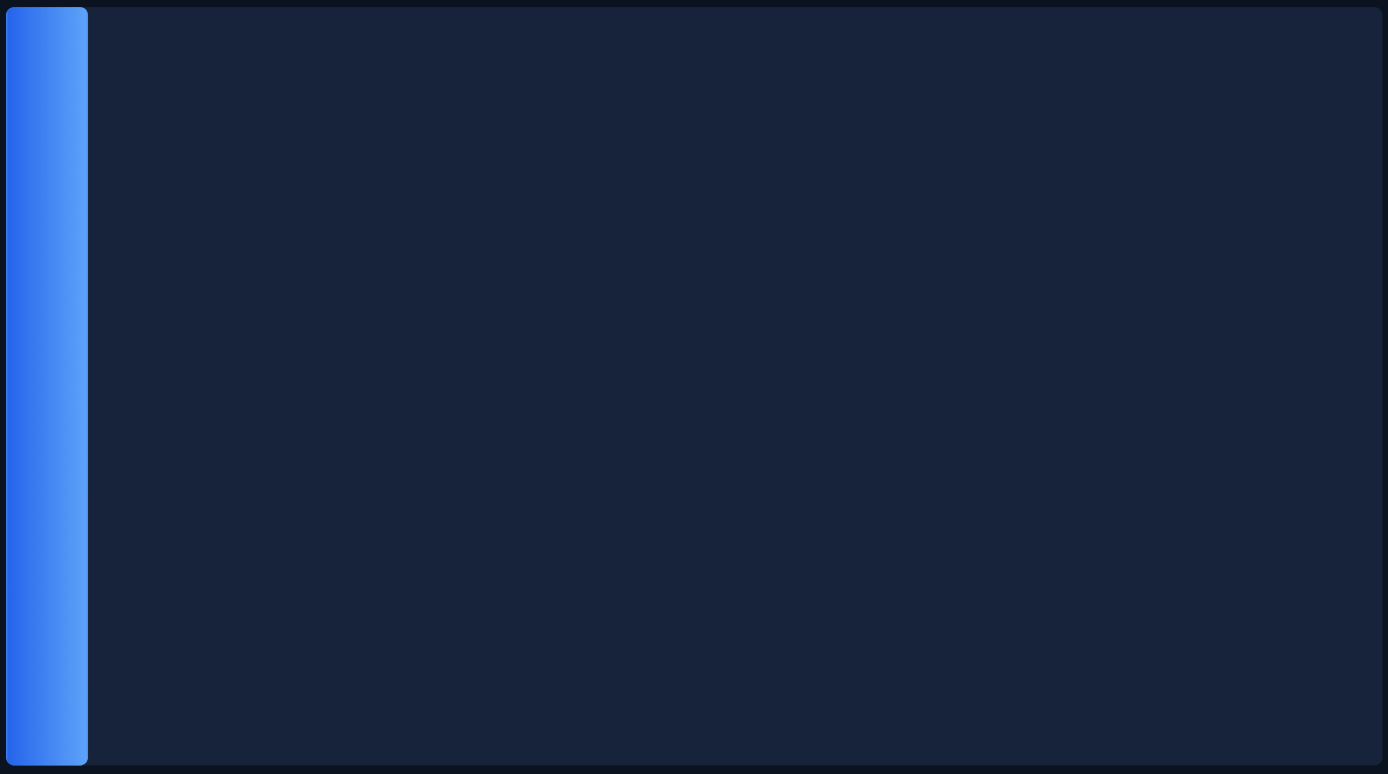


8	566	1	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

16 flightsim

github.com/alphasoc/flightsim

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.4k	GITHUB STARS
144	FORKS
2024-04	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
Go	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A utility to safely generate malicious network traffic patterns and evaluate controls."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

generates malicious network traffic for IDS/NDR validation; defender-side only.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by defenders safely generating malicious-looking network traffic; the free attack simulator for testing detections.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

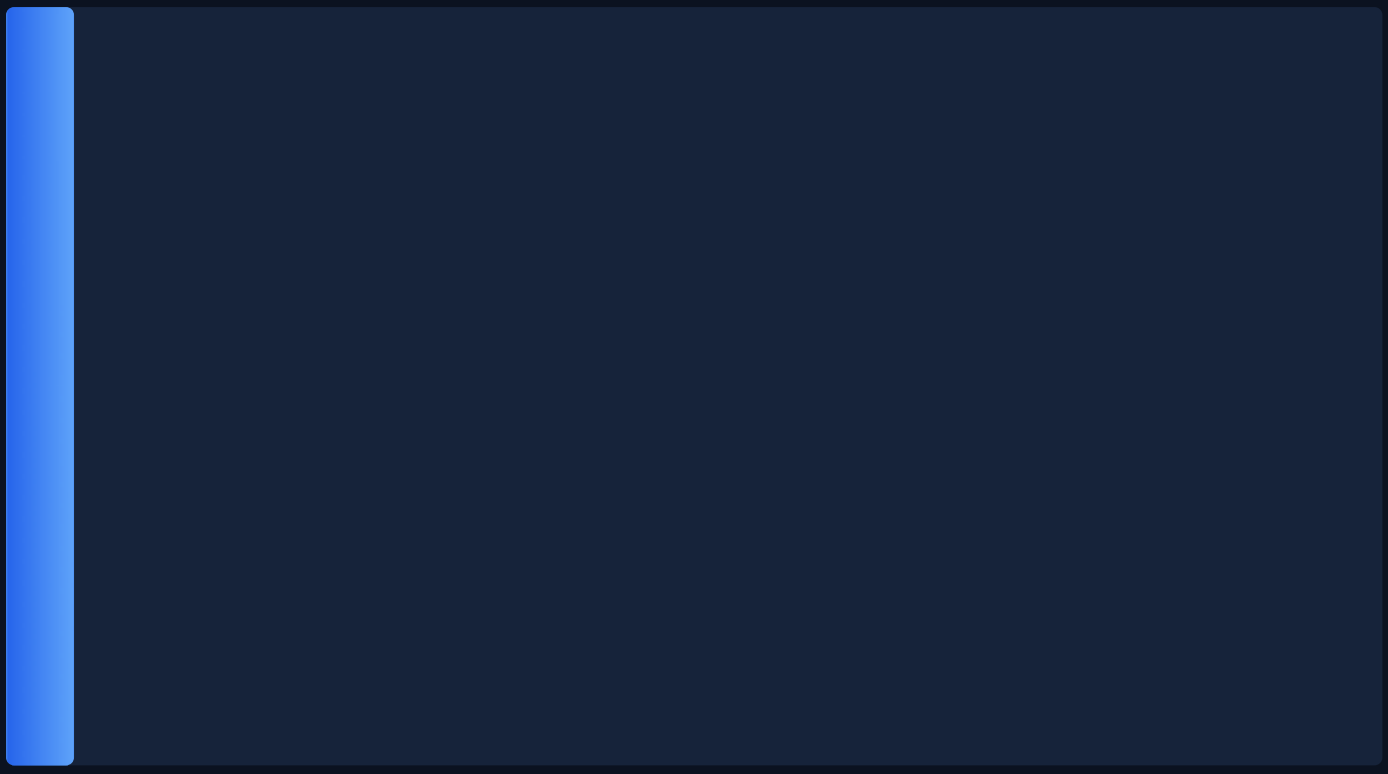


8	144	24	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

17 DIVA Android

github.com/payatu/diva-android

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.2k	GITHUB STARS
332	FORKS
2023-05	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
Java	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"DIVA Android - Damn Insecure and vulnerable App for Android"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Damn Insecure and Vulnerable App: the Android training classic.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by mobile security students learning Android flaw classes; the classic deliberately vulnerable Android app.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

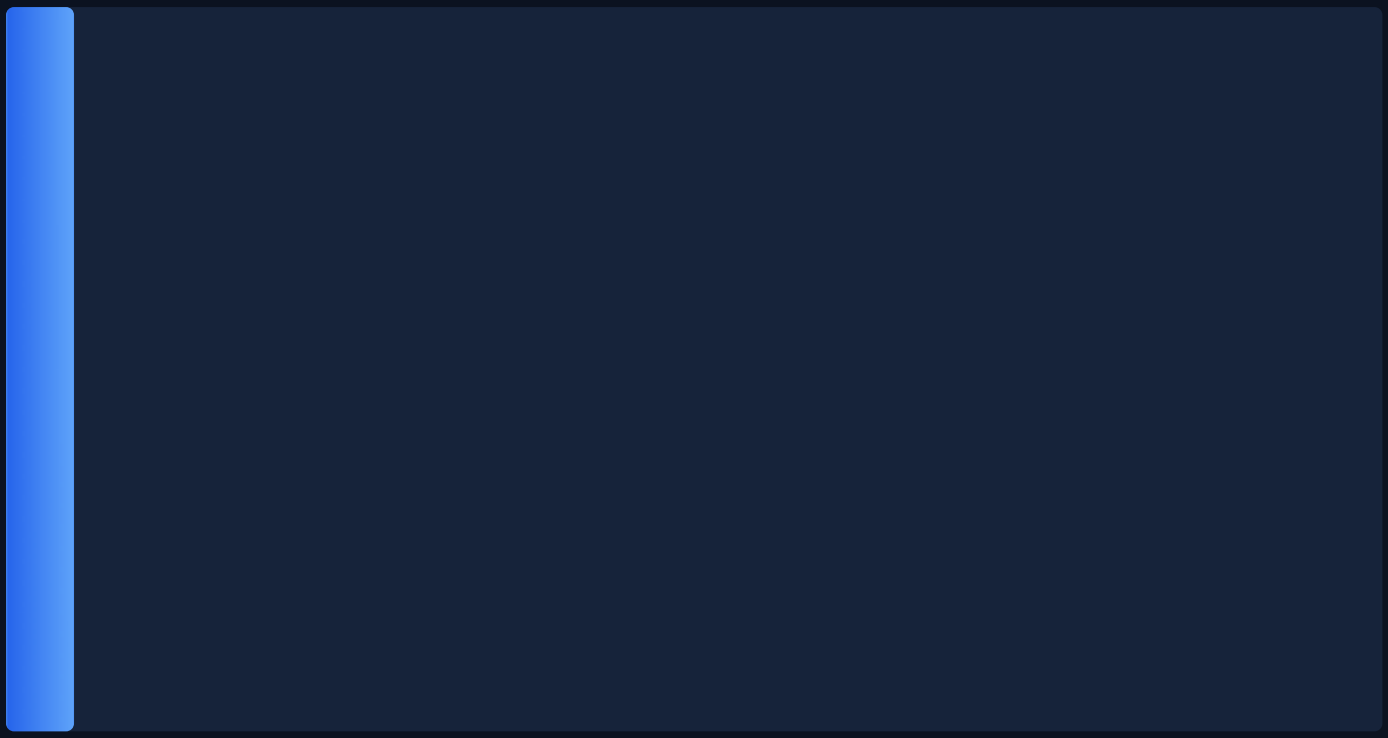


10	332	13	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

18 DVIA-v2

github.com/prateek147/DVIA-v2

star weight vs realm #1



★ 1.1k	GITHUB STARS
244	FORKS
2024-03	LAST PUSH
2018	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Swift	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Damn Vulnerable iOS App (DVIA) is an iOS application that is damn vulnerable. Its main goal is to provide a platform to mobile security enthusiasts/professionals or students to test their iOS penetration testing skills i"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Damn Vulnerable iOS App v2: the mobile testing curriculum as an app.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by iOS security learners practicing on Swift; the free deliberately vulnerable iOS app.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

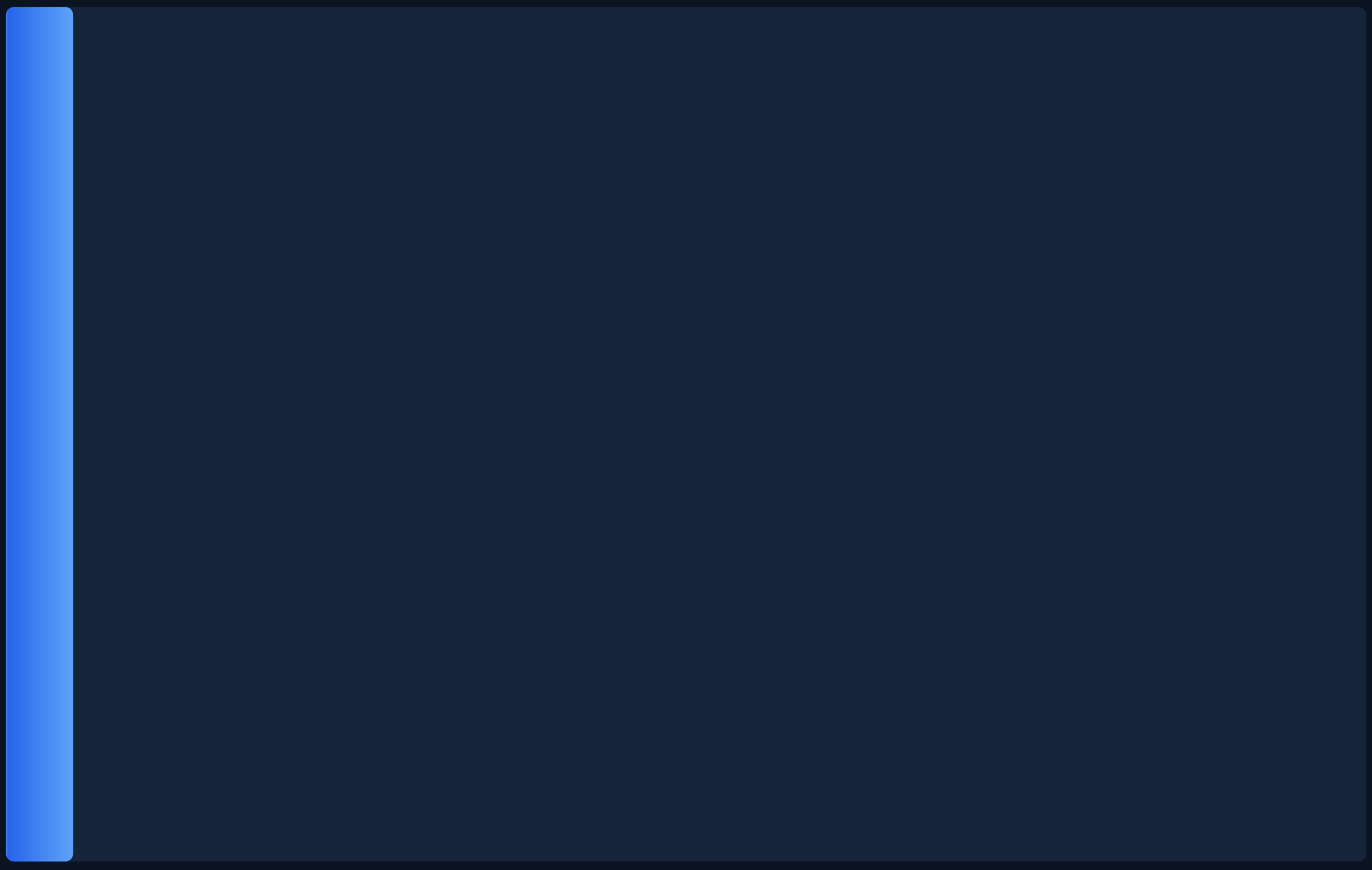


8	244	9	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

19 AzureGoat

github.com/ine-labs/AzureGoat

star weight vs realm #1



★ 967	GITHUB STARS
258	FORKS
2024-10	LAST PUSH
2022	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"AzureGoat : A Damn Vulnerable Azure Infrastructure"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the vulnerable-by-design Azure cloud lab. Used by cloud security learners practicing Azure attacks; the free vulnerable-by-design Azure lab.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



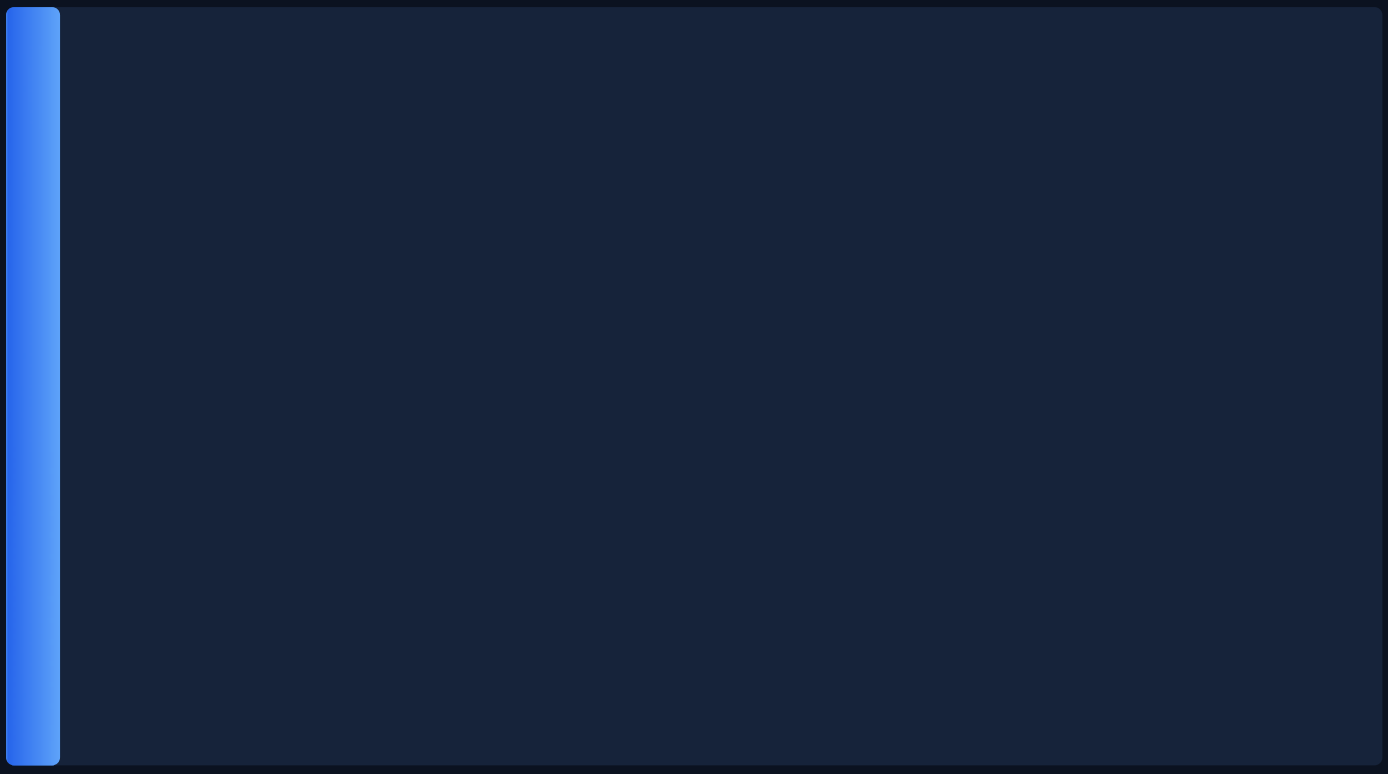
4	258	6	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

20 DSVW

github.com/stamparm/DSVW

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 883	GITHUB STARS
380	FORKS
2026-08	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
Unlicense	LICENSE
Python	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Damn Small Vulnerable Web"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Damn Small Vulnerable Web: the Top 10 in ~100 lines of Python.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by trainers demonstrating web flaws with a single Python file; the deliberately small vulnerable app. (public domain)

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



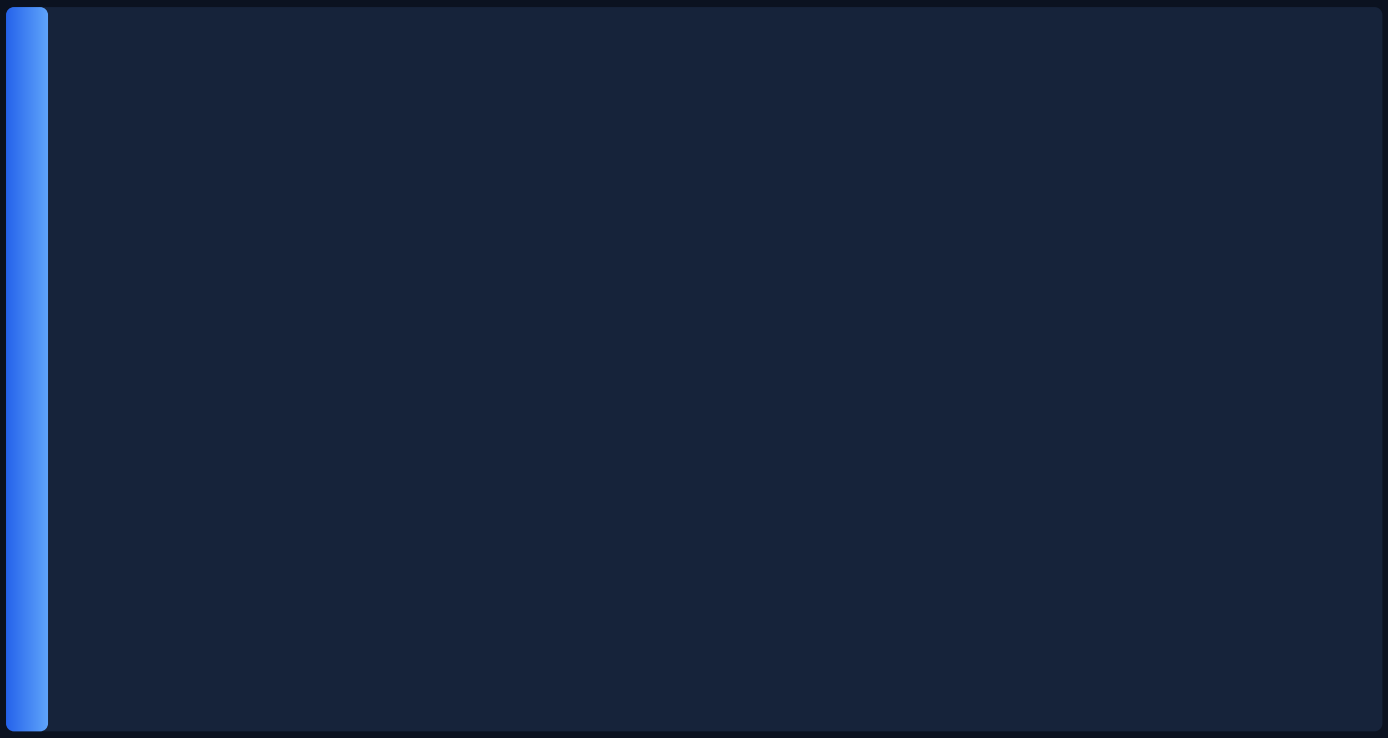
11 YEARS ON GITHUB	380 FORKS (REUSE)	1 OPEN ISSUES	yes 2026 MOMENTUM

21 Vulnerable Node

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/cr0hn/vulnerable-node

star weight vs realm #1



★ 493	GITHUB STARS
774	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
custom	LICENSE
JavaScript	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Vulnerable Nodejs — a real shop (NodeBazaar) intentionally full of security bugs. 14 labs, OWASP Top 10:2025, SAST benchmark. Node.js port of DVWA."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Node.js vulnerable application for testing analysis tools.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by Node.js teams auditing a realistic vulnerable app; the free Express-based training target.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

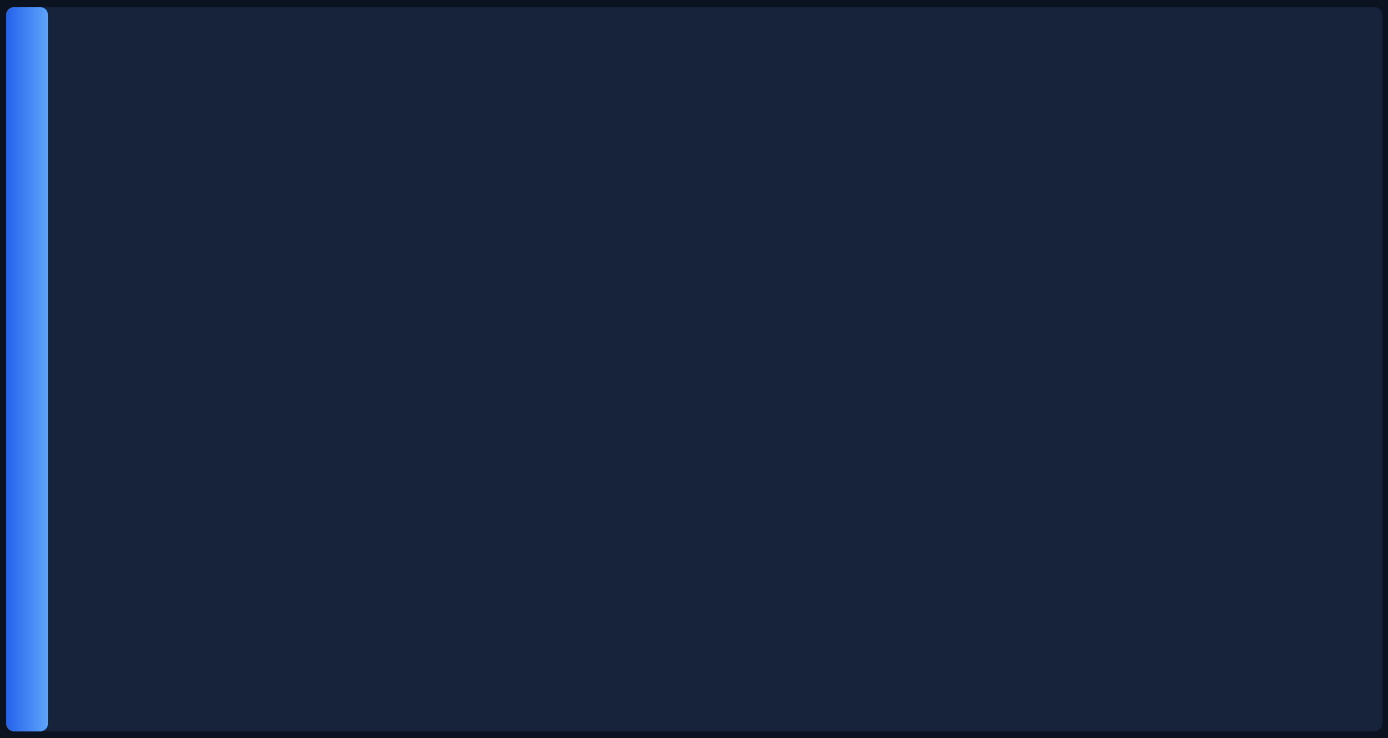


10	774	6	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

22 DVWS (Web Services)

github.com/snoopysecurity/dvws

star weight vs realm #1



★ 461	GITHUB STARS
137	FORKS
2021-12	LAST PUSH
2016	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
PHP	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Damn Vulnerable Web Services is an insecure web application with multiple vulnerable web service components that can be used to learn real world web service vulnerabilities. NOTE: This project is out of date, please use"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

vulnerable web services for SOA/API security practice.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by students practicing SOAP and REST attacks; the vulnerable web-services lab.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



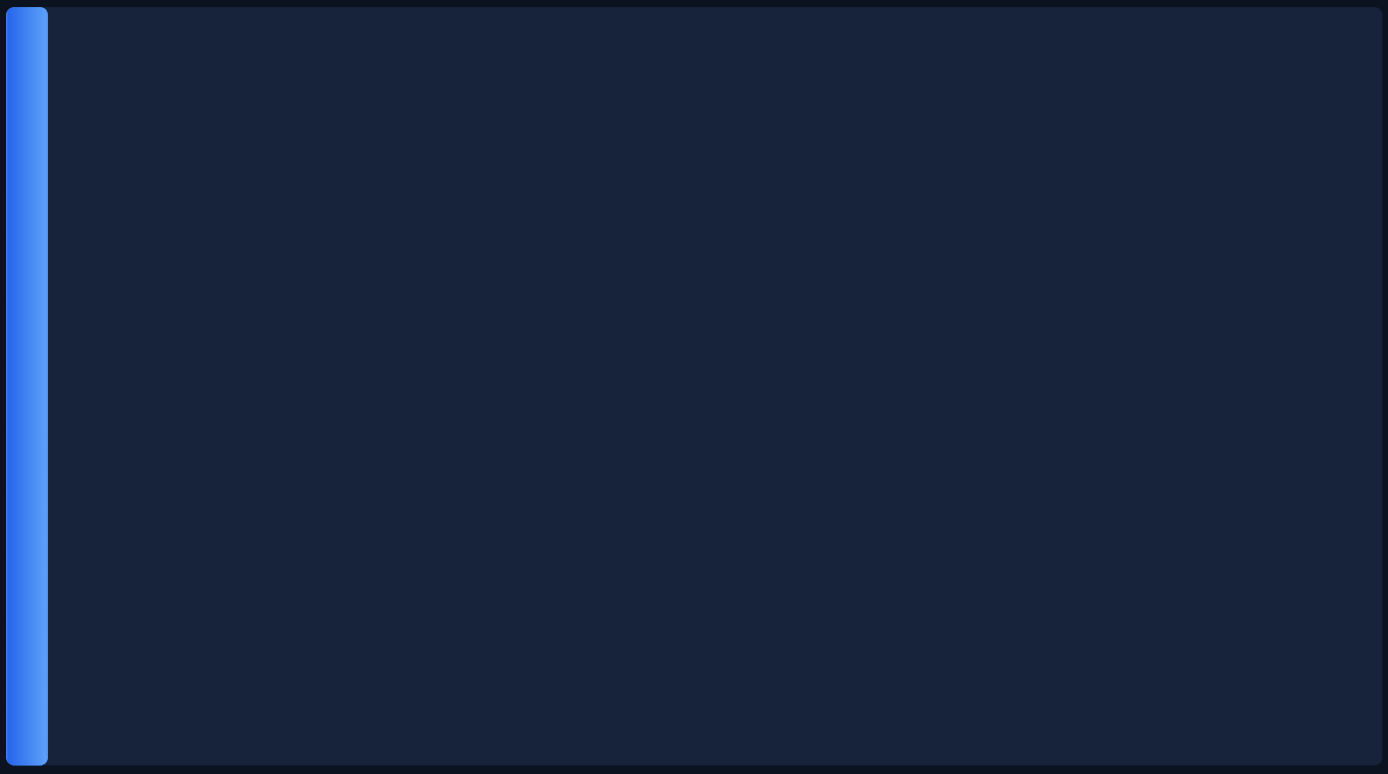
10	137	0	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

23 DVWS (Web Sockets)

ACTIVE 2026

github.com/interference-security/DVWS

star weight vs realm #1



★ 364	GITHUB STARS
80	FORKS
2026-07	LAST PUSH
2017	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
PHP	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OWSAP Damn Vulnerable Web Sockets (DVWS) is a vulnerable web application which works on web sockets for client-server communication."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the vulnerable WebSocket app from Interference Security.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by students practicing WebSocket-specific attacks; the vulnerable websockets lab.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

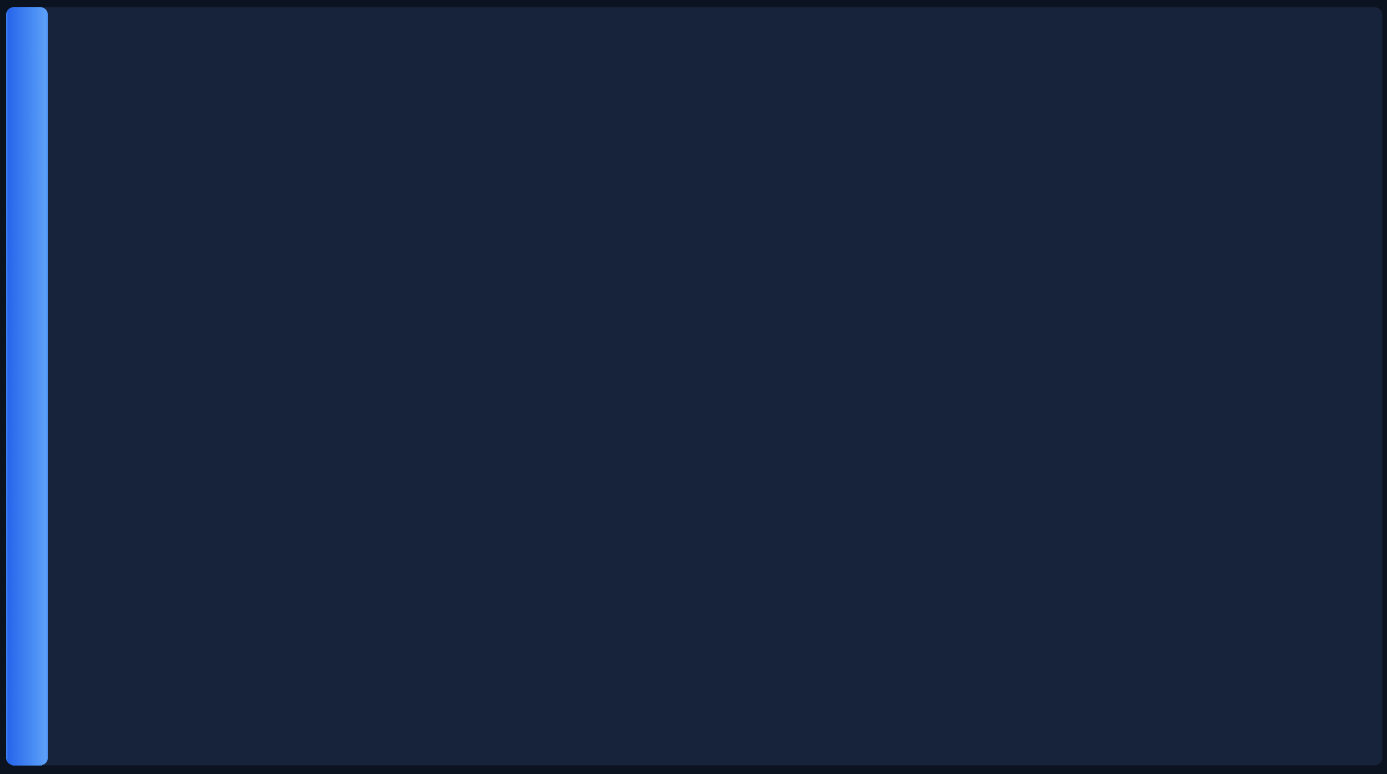


9	80	4	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

24 WackoPicko

github.com/adamdoupe/WackoPicko

star weight vs realm #1



★ 354	GITHUB STARS
231	FORKS
2024-05	LAST PUSH
2010	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
PHP	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"WackoPicko is a vulnerable web application used to test web application vulnerability scanners."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the vulnerable app built for testing vulnerability scanners — a frozen-by-design calibration target for your tooling.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by researchers and instructors demonstrating classic web flaws; the free academic vulnerable social network.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

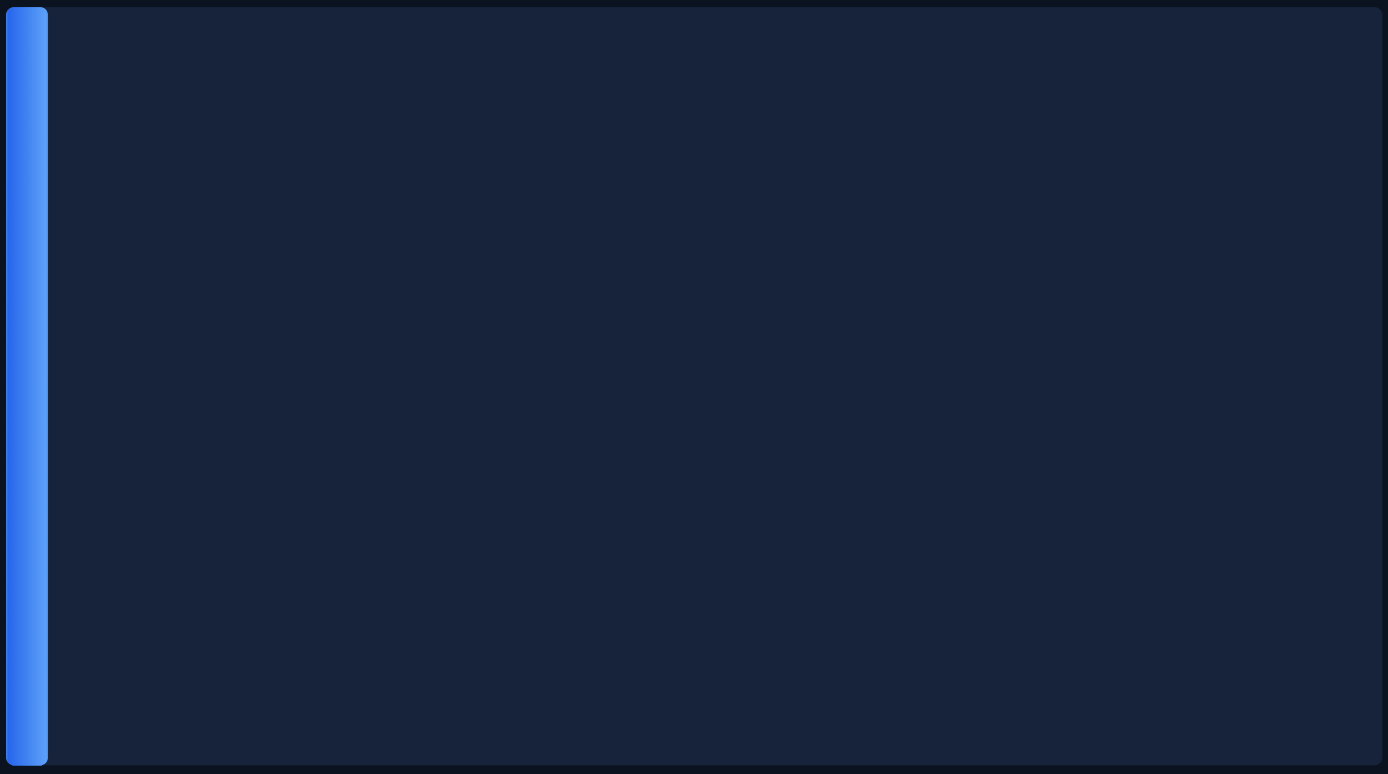


16	231	0	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

25 0l4bs

github.com/tegal1337/0l4bs

star weight vs realm #1



★ 350	GITHUB STARS
48	FORKS
2021-06	LAST PUSH
2020	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
PHP	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Cross-site scripting labs for web application security enthusiasts "

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

XSS practice labs with progressive difficulty.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by students practicing SQLi, XSS and command injection individually; the free isolated labs per bug class.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

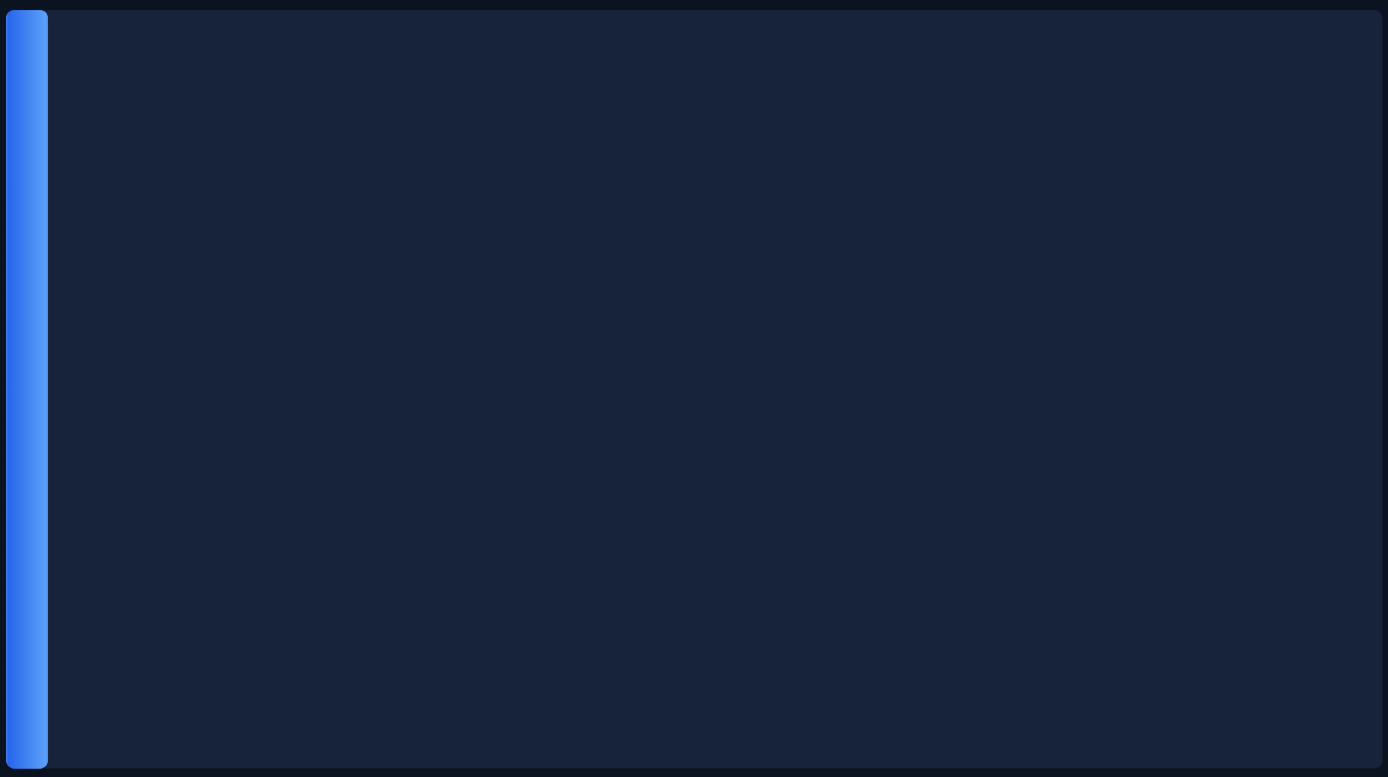


6	48	1	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

26 lfi-labs

github.com/paralax/lfi-labs

star weight vs realm #1



★ 335	GITHUB STARS
84	FORKS
2024-04	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
PHP	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"small set of PHP scripts to practice exploiting LFI, RFI and CMD injection vulns"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

LFI/RFI/commix practice pages: one flaw family, many variants.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by learners practicing local file inclusion safely; the free PHP lab for LFI classes.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

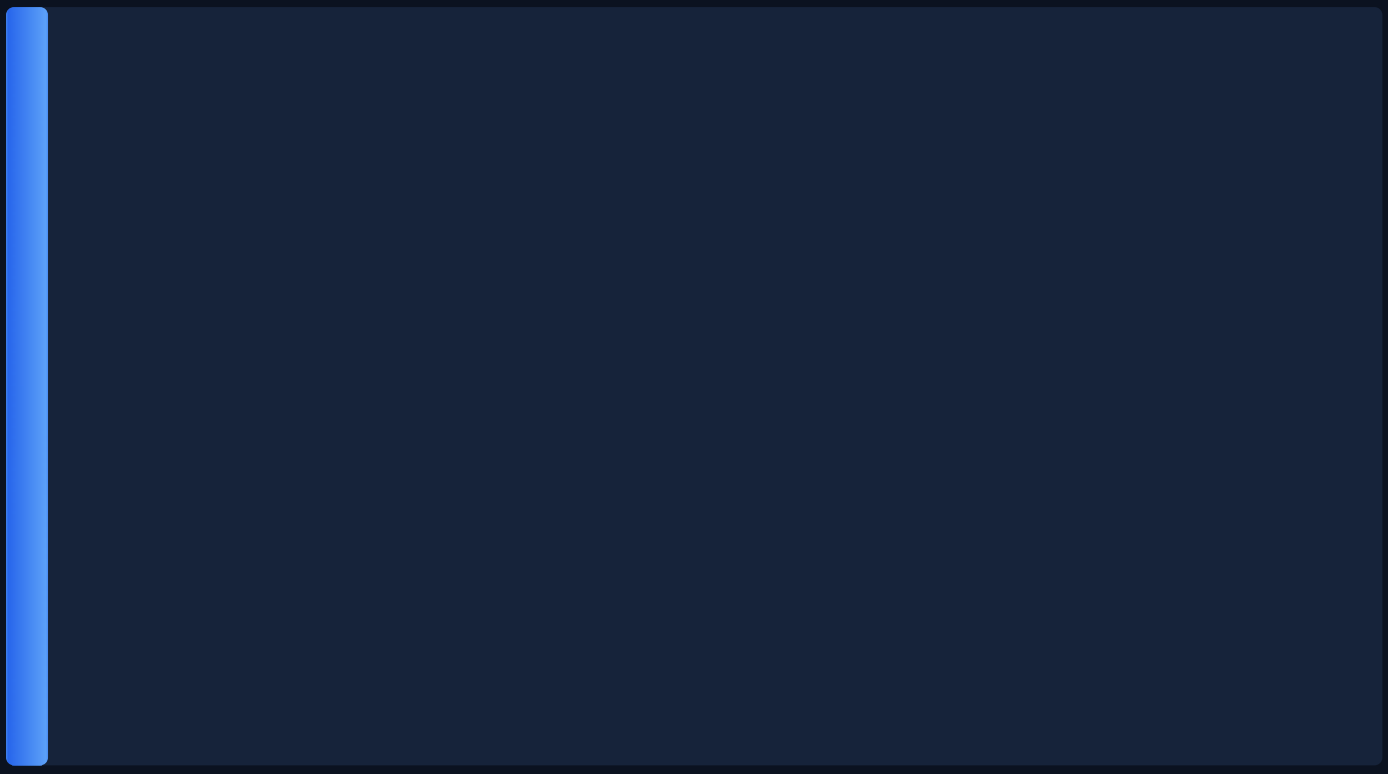


11 YEARS ON GITHUB	84 FORKS (REUSE)	4 OPEN ISSUES	— 2026 MOMENTUM

27 Hackademic

github.com/Hackademic/hackademic

star weight vs realm #1



★ 325	GITHUB STARS
116	FORKS
2020-10	LAST PUSH
2012	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
PHP	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"the main hackademic code repository"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

WordPress-based vulnerable lab scenarios for classroom use.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by learners practicing realistic web scenarios; the free vulnerable target used in RTB-era trainings.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



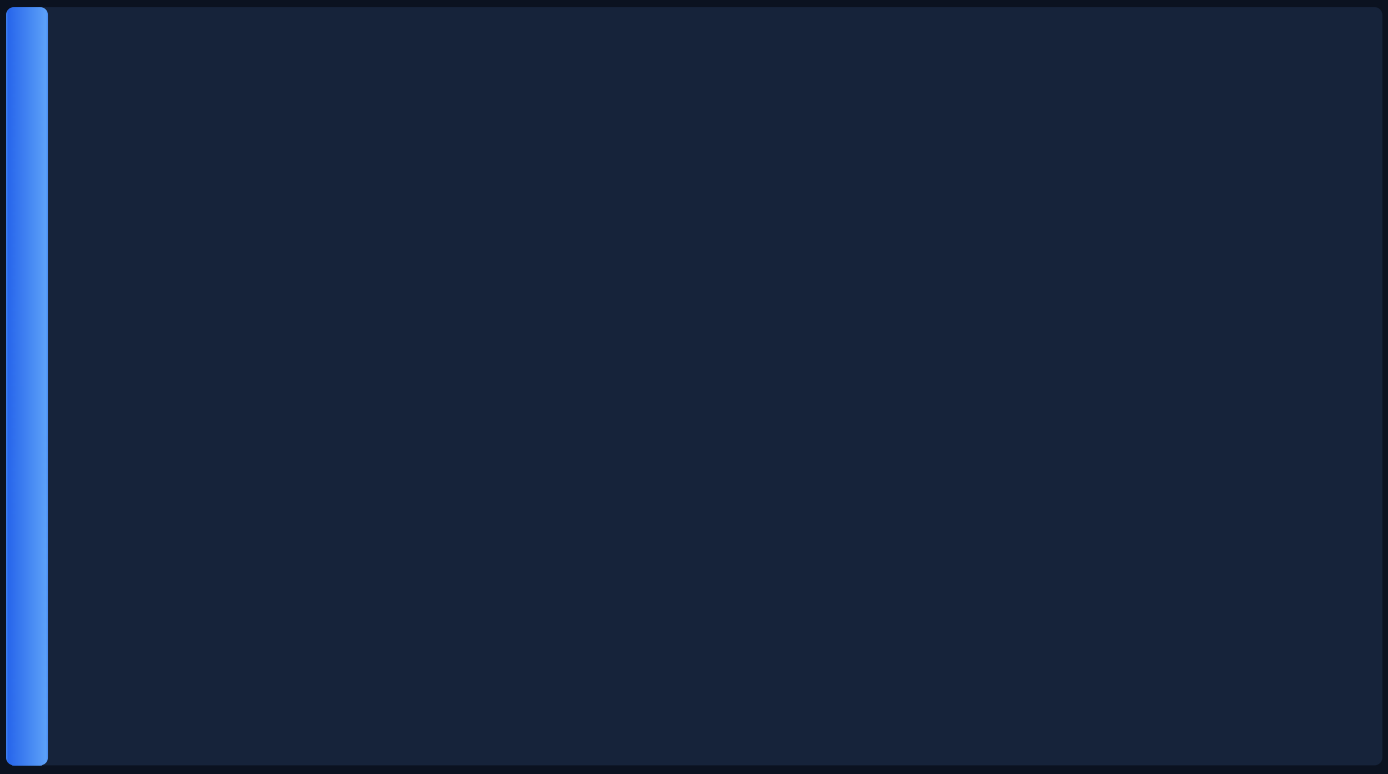
14	116	42	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

28 Java Vulnerable Lab

github.com/CSPF-Founder/JavaVulnerableLab

ACTIVE 2026

star weight vs realm #1



★ 278	GITHUB STARS
534	FORKS
2026-10	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-2.0	LICENSE
Java	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Vulnerable Java based Web Application"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Java vulnerable web application from the CSPF crew.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by Java developers learning exploitable patterns; the free vulnerable Java application.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

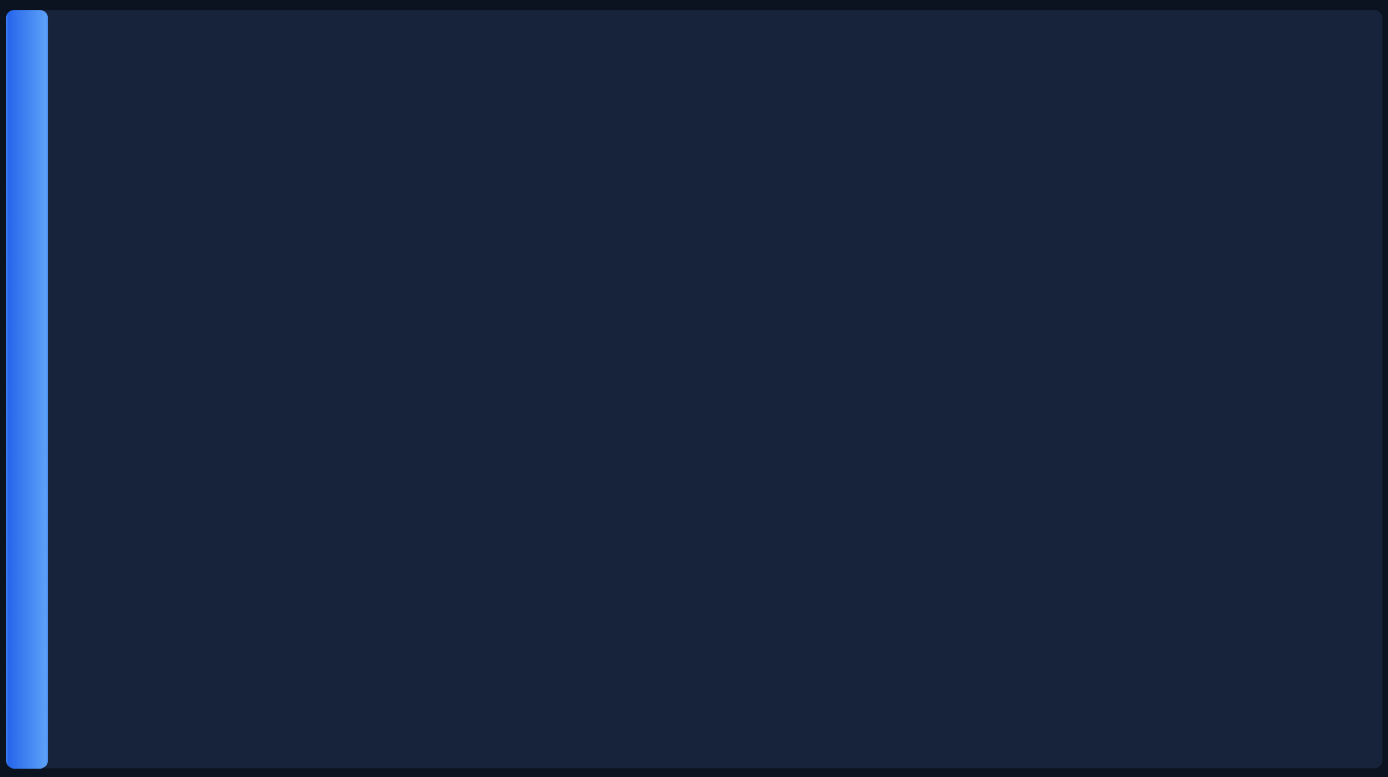


11	534	15	yes
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

29 DVHMA

github.com/logicalhacking/DVHMA

star weight vs realm #1



★ 274	GITHUB STARS
63	FORKS
2018-08	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
Apache-2.0	LICENSE
JavaScript	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Damn Vulnerable Hybrid Mobile App (DVHMA) is an hybrid mobile app (for Android) that intentionally contains vulnerabilities."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the Damn Vulnerable Hybrid Mobile App: Android+iOS appsec in one codebase.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by mobile security students practicing hybrid-app flaws; the vulnerable hybrid mobile app lab.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

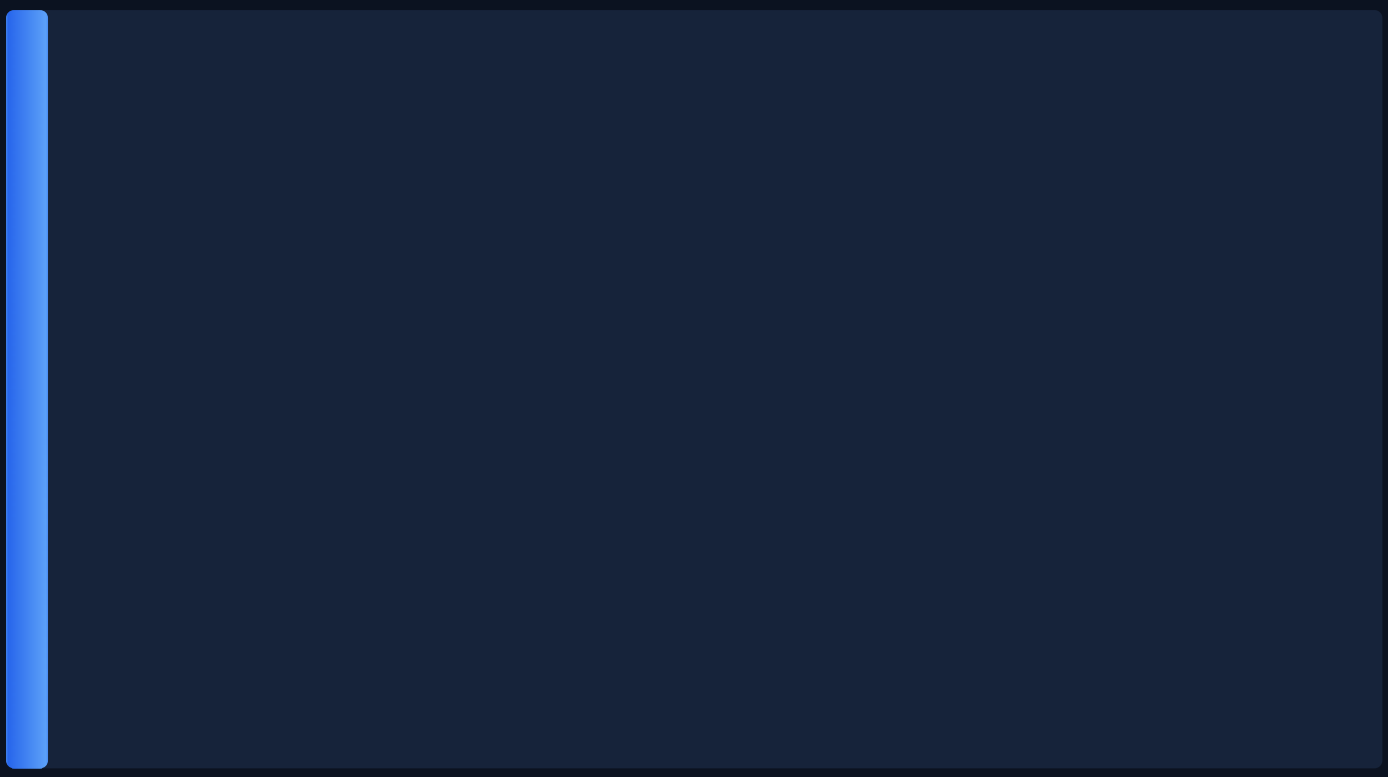


11	63	0	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

30 CryptOMG

github.com/SpiderLabs/CryptOMG

star weight vs realm #1



★ 195	GITHUB STARS
54	FORKS
2015-06	LAST PUSH
2012	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
PHP	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"CryptOMG is a configurable CTF style test bed that highlights common flaws in cryptographic implementations."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

cryptographic flaw testbed from SpiderLabs.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by crypto learners attacking flawed implementations; the free crypto-focused challenge set.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

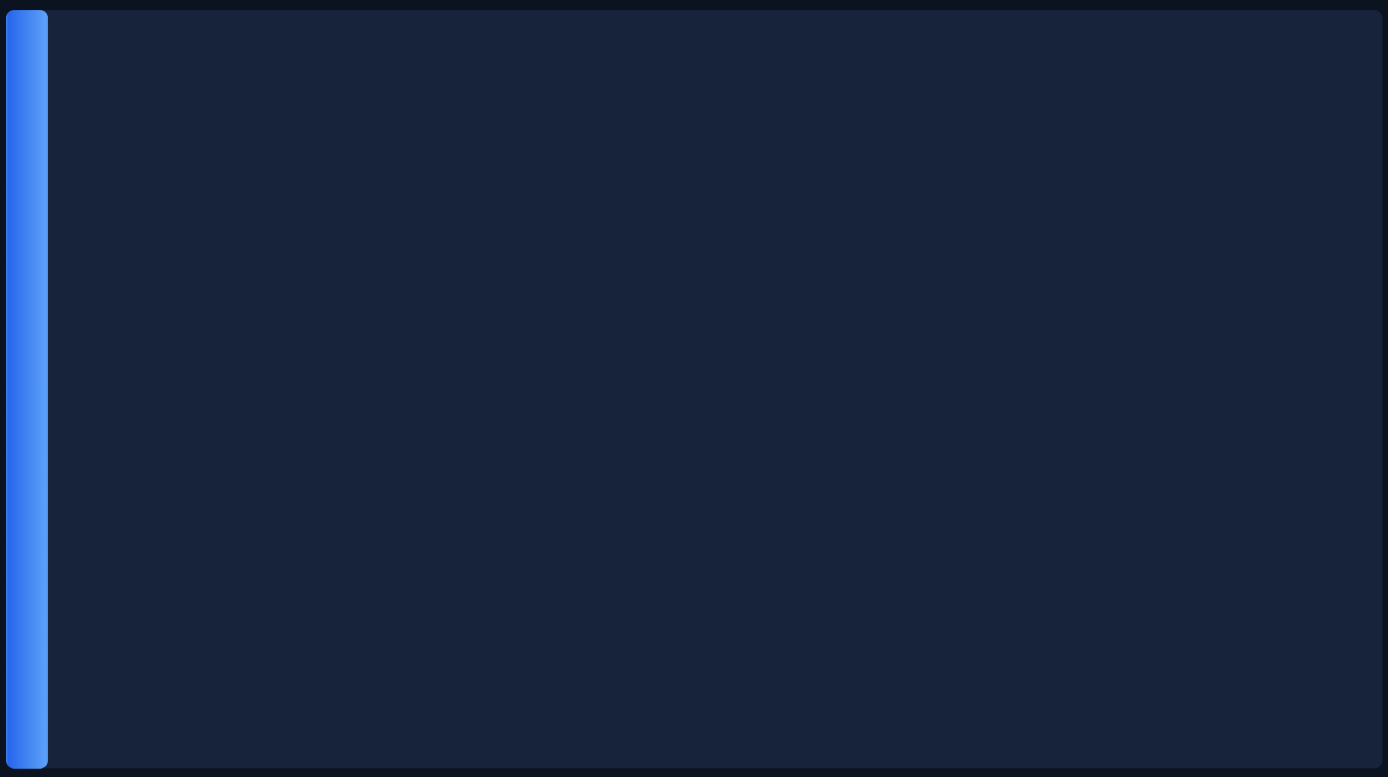


14	54	0	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

31 damnvulnerable.me

github.com/skepticfx/damnvulnerable.me

star weight vs realm #1



★ 34	GITHUB STARS
6	FORKS
2019-05	LAST PUSH
2015	FIRST DEVELOPED
MIT	LICENSE
HTML	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"A deliberately vulnerable modern day app with lots of DOM related bugs"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

a modern vulnerable webapp for the OWASP Top 10 era.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by mobile security students learning both Android and iOS flaws; the free vulnerable mobile apps.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)

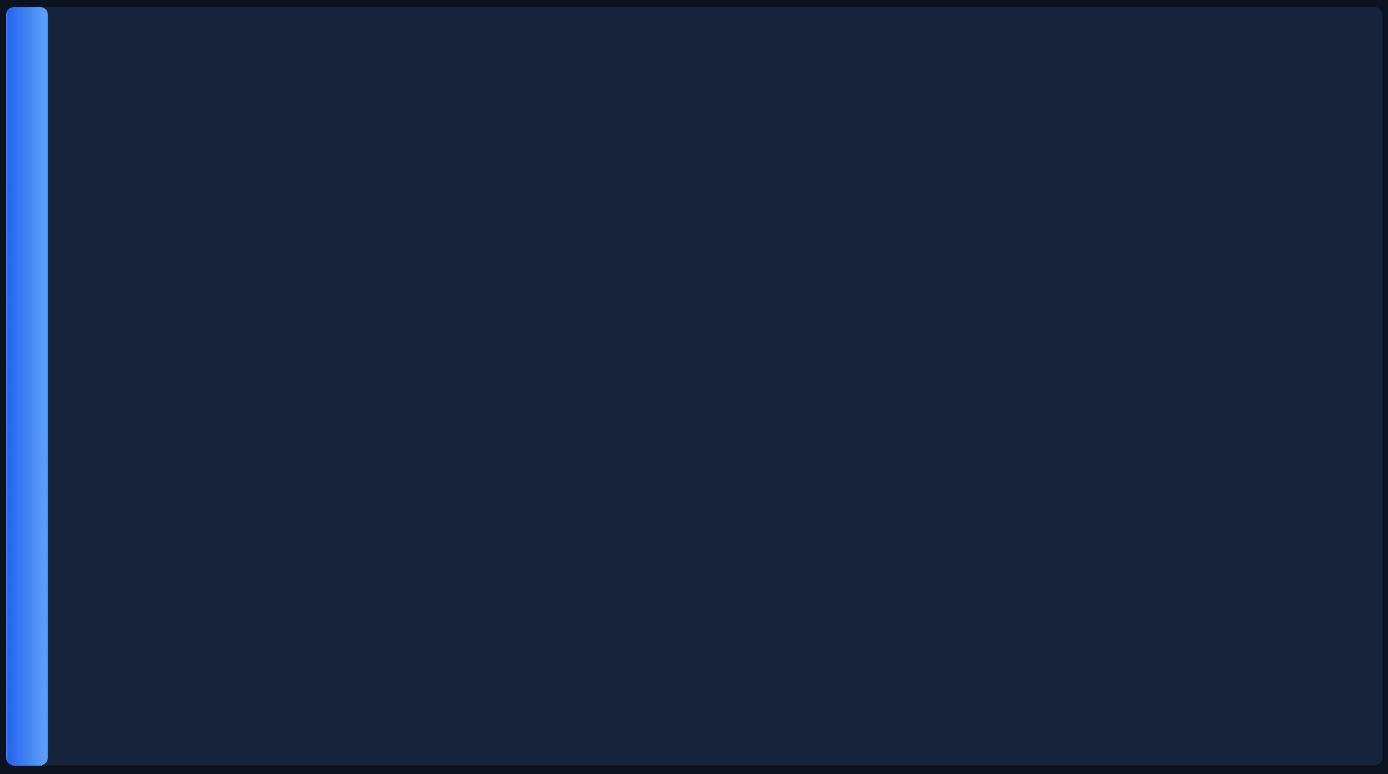


11	6	6	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

32 SentinelTestbed

github.com/dobin/SentinelTestbed

star weight vs realm #1



★ 11	GITHUB STARS
12	FORKS
2016-11	LAST PUSH
2013	FIRST DEVELOPED
GPL-3.0	LICENSE
PHP	LANGUAGE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Vulnerable web site. Used to test sentinel features."

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

a testbed app for evaluating security instrumentation.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by engineers testing detection content against a deliberately vulnerable host; the free detection-lab target.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



13	12	0	—
YEARS ON GITHUB	FORKS (REUSE)	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

33 Altoro Mutual

http://demo.testfire.net/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Altoro Mutual"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the classic demo bank: legal target for appsec training and tool demos.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by security teams demoing scanners on a safe target; the classic IBM testfire-style demo banking site. (free service)

34 Arizona Cyber Warfare Range

WEB / STANDALONE

http://azcwr.org/az-cyber-warfare-ranges

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Arizona Cyber Warfare Range"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

free live-fire ranges for defenders and researchers.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by learners attacking live-fire lab environments; the free volunteer-run range. (free service)

35 bWAPP

http://www.itsecgames.com/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“bWAPP”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the "buggy web application" with 100+ vulnerability flavors — an old-school playground that still teaches.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by instructors demonstrating 100+ web bug classes; the free buggy app for classroom labs.

36 Crackmes.one

crackmes.one/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Crackmes.one"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the reverse-engineering challenge community: thousands of crackmes, all legal.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by reverse-engineering learners practicing on thousands of binaries; the free community crackme archive. (free service)

37 CryptoHack

cryptohack.org/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"CryptoHack"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

learn modern cryptography by breaking it: challenges from classical ciphers to ECC.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by learners leveling up applied cryptography; the free interactive challenge platform.

38 Cryptopals

cryptopals.com

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Cryptopals"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the legendary crypto challenges; finish them and AES is no longer magic.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by engineers learning real-world cryptography; the free challenge set that trained a generation of crypto implementers.

39 CTFlearn

ctflearn.com/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"CTFlearn"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the beginner-friendly CTF platform with a permanent challenge set.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by absolute beginners solving first flags; the free beginner-friendly CTF platform. (free service)

40 CTFtime

ctftime.org

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"CTFtime"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the global CTF calendar, team rankings and writeup index — the hub of the sport.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by CTF teams tracking events and rankings worldwide; the free calendar of every serious competition.

41 CyberDefenders

cyberdefenders.org/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"CyberDefenders"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

blue-team CTF platform: investigate realistic incidents with the tools a SOC actually uses.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by aspiring DFIR analysts practicing blue-team cases; the free DFIR CTF platform. (free tier)

42 ExploitMe Mobile

WEB / STANDALONE

http://securitycompass.github.io/AndroidLabs/index.html

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“ExploitMe Mobile”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the SecurityCompass mobile labs. Used by mobile security learners practicing iPhone and Android labs; the free mobile range. (free service)

43 Firing Range

public-firing-range.appspot.com/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Firing Range”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Google's XSS testbed: the original scanner benchmarking target.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by XSS researchers testing payloads systematically; Google's free testbed for cross-site scripting classes.

44 Gandalf

gandalf.lakera.ai

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Gandalf"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Lakera's free prompt-injection game; learn AI-security attacks hands-on, level by level.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by teams learning prompt injection hands-on; Lakera's free AI-security game.

45 Google Gruyere

http://google-gruyere.appspot.com/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Google Gruyere"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Google's cheese-themed vulnerable web app: exploit XSS, XSRF and information disclosure in the cloud.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by beginners hunting their first web bugs; Google's free vulnerable-app tutorial.

46 Hack The Box

www.hackthebox.com

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Hack The Box”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the platform for ranked machines, pro labs and active-dir ranges; the industry's proving ground.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by aspiring OSCP candidates and professional pentesters keeping sharp; the leading freemium training range. (free tier)

47 Hack This Site

www.hackthissite.org/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Hack This Site”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the community wargames veteran: missions, articles and forums since the early 2000s.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by a generation of learners starting out; the veteran free training community.

48 Hackertest.net

http://www.hackertest.net/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Hackertest.net"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the 20-level hacking simulation for web basics.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by beginners playing a level-by-level web puzzle; the veteran free challenge series. (free service)

49 HackThis!!

www.hackthis.co.uk/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"HackThis!!"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

50+ levels of web security challenges, from basics to advanced.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by beginners practicing across 50+ mission levels; the free UK challenge community. (free service)

50 Hackxor

hackxor.net/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Hackxor"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

a realistic web-app hacking game with a story arc — WebGoat with sharper teeth.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by aspiring web hackers playing a realistic first-person hacking game; the free browser-based range.

51 LetsDefend

letsdefend.io/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"LetsDefend"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

browser-based SOC simulator: alert queues, playbooks and IR challenges mapped to MITRE ATT&CK.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by aspiring SOC analysts simulating alert triage; the freemium blue-team range with realistic cases. (free tier)

52 MASTG Crackmes

github.com/OWASP/mastg/tree/master/Crackmes

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"MASTG Crackmes"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the mobile RE challenges companion to the OWASP MASTG.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by mobile security learners practicing the OWASP MASTG on real targets; the free crackme suite.

53 Microcorruption

WEB / STANDALONE

microcorruption.com/

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Microcorruption"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

embedded-security CTF: reverse the lock firmware, level by level.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by embedded security learners solving lock-firmware puzzles; the free embedded CTF from Matasano lineage. (free service)

54 MysteryTwister C3

www.mysterytwisterc3.org/en/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"MysteryTwister C3"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the international cryptography challenge: from Caesar to quantum.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by crypto enthusiasts solving graded cipher challenges; the free crypto CTF with legendary pedigree. (free service)

55 OverTheWire

overthewire.org

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OverTheWire"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Bandit and friends: learn Linux, networking and protocols through SSH wargames.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by learners mastering Linux and security fundamentals; the classic free wargames every starter list recommends.

56 OWASP iGoat

wiki.owasp.org/index.php/OWASP_iGoat_Tool_Project

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"OWASP iGoat"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the iOS learning app from the OWASP mobile family.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by iOS security learners practicing on Objective-C; the OWASP deliberately vulnerable iOS app. (wiki project)

57 Pentest-Ground

pentest-ground.com/

WEB / STANDALONE

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NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Pentest-Ground"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

hosted practice playground of intentionally vulnerable apps for security testing.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by testers practicing against free lab environments; the training range from the Netsparker lineage. (free service)

58 picoCTF

picoctf.org

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"picoCTF"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

CMU's beginner-friendly CTF — the best first flag anyone can capture.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by high-school and university students in CMU's free beginner CTF; the on-ramp for countless security careers.

59 pwnable.kr

pwnable.kr/

WEB / STANDALONE

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NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“pwnable.kr”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the classic system-hacking wargame: exploit your way from userland to kernel.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by exploit developers practicing binary pwn; the classic free challenge server.

60 Reversing.kr

http://reversing.kr

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Reversing.kr”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the classic Korean reverse-engineering challenge site.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by RE learners practicing Korean-style binary challenges; the classic free challenge site. (free service)

61 RingZer0 CTF

ringzer0ctf.com/

WEB / STANDALONE

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NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"RingZer0 CTF"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

hundreds of challenges across web, crypto, forensics and reversing.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by learners solving web, crypto and coding challenges; the free online CTF platform. (free service)

62 Root Me

www.root-me.org/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Root Me"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

hundreds of real-world hacking challenges across dozens of categories, from web to stego.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by French-speaking and international learners; the free platform with hundreds of hands-on challenges. (free tier)

63 SmashTheStack

WEB / STANDALONE

http://smashthestack.org/

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NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"SmashTheStack"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the wargames network: shellcoding, exploitation and logic puzzles.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by learners playing classic wargames like Amateria and Blowfish; the veteran free wargame community. (free service)

64 SocketToMe

digi.ninja/projects/sockettome.php

WEB / STANDALONE

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NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"SocketToMe"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Robin Wood's WebSocket testing challenge app.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by learners practicing network socket exploitation; the free deliberately vulnerable service. (free service)

65 techlogia Lab

techlogia.de/en/lab

WEB / STANDALONE

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NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“techlogia Lab”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

free browser-based hacking lab for security training.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by students practicing end-to-end web exploitation; the free vulnerable lab environment.

66 testasp.vulnweb.com

http://testasp.vulnweb.com/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“testasp.vulnweb.com”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the ASP demo target for scanner testing. Used by scanner developers and QA validating detection; Acunetix's free intentionally-vulnerable classic ASP test site. (free service)

67 testaspnet.vulnweb.com

http://testaspnet.vulnweb.com/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“testaspnet.vulnweb.com”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the ASP.NET demo target for scanner testing.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by scanner developers and QA validating detection; Acunetix's free intentionally-vulnerable ASP.NET test site. (free service)

68 TryHackMe

tryhackme.com

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"TryHackMe"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

guided rooms from your first command to advanced red/blue paths — the friendliest on-ramp.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by newcomers learning security step by step; the guided-labs platform that made entry-level training free. (free tier)

69 VulnHub

www.vulnhub.com

WEB / STANDALONE

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NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"VulnHub"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

downloadable vulnerable VMs; build and break your own home lab offline.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by students building offline home labs; the free vulnerable-VM library that replaced expensive lab hardware.

70 Vulnserver

WEB / STANDALONE

http://www.thegreycorner.com/2010/12/introducing-vulnserver.html

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NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Vulnserver”

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the TCP vulnerable server for exploit-dev practice.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by exploit developers practicing buffer overflows and ROP; the standard free TCP exploitation trainer. (free service)

71 W3Challs

w3challs.com

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"W3Challs"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

pentest training challenges with a ranking system.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by learners practicing web, crypto and stego; the free challenge platform. (free service)

72 WeChall

http://www.wechall.net/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"WeChall"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the challenge-site aggregator: one profile across all major wargames.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by CTF players tracking ranks across challenge sites; the free aggregator for wargame rankings. (free service)

73 XSS Game

xss-game.appspot.com/

WEB / STANDALONE

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NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"XSS Game"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Google's XSS tutorial game: six levels from context basics to DOM tricks.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by beginners learning XSS exploitation; Google's free reverse-engineering-free XSS CTF. (free service)

74 Zero Bank

http://zero.webappsecurity.com/

WEB / STANDALONE

—

NOT GITHUB-HOSTED · WEBSITE / STANDALONE

THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"Zero Bank"

CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

demo banking site for web security exercises.

WHO USES IT · WHAT IT REPLACES

Used by learners practicing web vulns on a simulated banking app; the free demo target behind Invicti training material. (free service)

04 Realm Directory

74 curated entries · A–Z

0l4bs
Altoro Mutual
APTSimulator
Arizona Cyber Warfare Range
AzureGoat
bWAPP
CloudGoat
Crackmes.one
CryptoHack
CryptOMG
Cryptopals
CTFd
CTFlearn
CTFtime
CyberDefenders
damnvulnerable.me
DIVA Android
DSVW
DVHMA
DVIA-v2
DVWA
DVWS (Web Services)
DVWS (Web Sockets)
ExploitMe Mobile
Firing Range
flightsim
Gandalf
GOAD
Google Gruyere
Hack The Box
Hack This Site
Hackademic
Hackertest.net
HackThis!!
Hackxor
HEVD
Java Vulnerable Lab
LetsDefend
lfi-labs
MASTG Crackmes
Metasploitable 3
Microcorruption
MysteryTwister C3
OverTheWire
OWASP iGoat
OWASP Juice Shop
OWASP Mutillidae II
OWASP NodeGoat
Pentest-Ground
picoCTF
pwnable.kr
pwntools
Reversing.kr
RingZer0 CTF
Root Me
SentinelTestbed
SmashTheStack
SocketToMe
Splunk Attack Range
techlogia Lab
testasp.vulnweb.com
testaspnet.vulnweb.com
TryHackMe
Vulhub
Vulnerable Node
VulnHub
Vulnserver
W3Challs
WackoPicko
WebGoat
WeChall
XSS Game
XVWA
Zero Bank